



PARLIAMENTARY DEBATES

OFFICIAL REPORT

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THE
PARLIAMENT OF THE REPUBLIC
OF GHANA

SECOND MEETING, 2025

Wednesday, 9th July, 2025

The House met at 3.28 p.m.

[MR FIRST DEPUTY SPEAKER IN
THE CHAIR]

[PRAYERS]

ABSENCE OF THE SPEAKER

Deputy Clerk (Mr Camillo Pwamang) on behalf of the Clerk to Parliament: Hon Members, pursuant to Order 12(2) of the Standing Orders, I respectfully bring to your kind attention the unavoidable absence of the Rt Hon Speaker. Accordingly, the Hon First Deputy Speaker shall perform the duties and exercise the authority of the Speaker in relation to all proceedings of the House until the Speaker resumes the Chair.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, the item numbered 5 — Correction of *Votes and Proceedings* and the *Official Report*.

**VOTES AND PROCEEDINGS AND
THE OFFICIAL REPORT**

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, I have in my hand the *Votes and Proceedings* of Tuesday, 8th July, 2025.

Page 1... 8—

Prof Kingsley Nyarko: Mr Speaker, with respect, at page 8—Page 7—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Are you talking with reference to page 7 or 8?

Prof Nyarko: Mr Speaker, page 8, please.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well.

Prof Nyarko: Mr Speaker, at page 8, the item numbered 5 (b) (iv), I would like the Table to check the correct name for “Augustine Ahinful”, especially the spelling of “Ahinful”, whether it is spelt as “Ar” or without the “r”. This is because it has been spelt here as A-h-i-n-f-u-l, but I am thinking it should be “A-r-h...”, so they should kindly check and do the reconciliation.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: The list from which I made the announcement, it is spelt as “A-h”.

Prof Nyarko: That is why I said they should check because at times, it is spelt with “A-r”.

I am guided; thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, once it is emanating from them, I believe the spelling is correct.

Prof Nyarko: No problem, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Page 9—

Mr Abdul-Fatawu Alhassan: Mr Speaker, still at page 8, the item numbered 5 (a) ii ends with, "...led by a Teacher, Holly Boadi". Mr Speaker, is the "Holly" referring to a name?

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes. That is the correct spelling. I did not pronounce it well; I am familiar with "Boodi", so I mentioned "Boodi" and Mr Sampson Ahi said it was "Boadi".

Page 9...10—

Yes, Mr Frank Afriyie?

Prof Nyarko — *rose* —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: I would come to you, Prof Nyarko.

Mr Frank Afriyie: Mr Speaker, with respect, I invite you to the page under review, the item numbered 9 (d). The proper rendition of the office for the Minister in question is "Government Communications", so if the Clerks-at-the-Table could insert an "s" at the end of "Communication" to make it "Communications".

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well. Table, kindly take note.

Yes, Prof Kingsley Nyarko?

Prof Nyarko: Mr Speaker, it is the same observation that has been corrected by the Hon Member.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well.

Page 11—

Prof Nyarko: Mr Speaker, at page 11, at the apex of the page, the name of the Committee in Order 207(1) is "Committee on Trade, Industry and Tourism; it is not "Committee on Trade and Industry".

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Member, you are right.

Prof Nyarko: Mr Speaker, if I find favour before you, the item numbered 10 reads: "Ruling from the Chair...". Is it ruling from your good self or the Speaker? Which is which? Is it the Chair or the First Deputy Speaker, Mr Bernard Ahiafor?

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So, do you want my name to be indicated?

Prof Nyarko: Mr Speaker, not your name, but I am asking if it should be the Chair or the Speaker?

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well. Table—Prof Kingsley Nyarko, they normally use "Chair" because of the confusion that led to the definition of "The Speaker" and "Mr Speaker" as contained in the Interpretation column of the Standing Orders.

Prof Nyarko: Mr Speaker, I am guided. This means that we need to go to the Standing Orders and crosscheck under Interpretation to make sure that we capture it correctly.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well.

Page 12...14—

Dr Fred Kyei Asamoah: Mr Speaker, at page 13, the item numbered 13, under “Withdrawal of a Bill”, reads:

“The Hon Minister for Fisheries and Aquaculture, Mrs Emelia Arthur, in accordance with to Order 173...”

So, we will have to delete “to”.

3.38 p.m.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: That is correct, Hon Member. Table, take note.

Thank you very much, Hon Member.

Page 15. Yes, Hon Frank Afriyie?

Mr Afriyie: Mr Speaker, thank you once again. Mr Speaker, on page 15, line 2 of the first item, there is a group by name “Canoe and Fishing Gear Association”. I think after the “Fishing Gear”, “Owners” should be inserted. The proper name of the group should be “Canoe and Fishing Gear Owners Association of Ghana”.

Mr Speaker, if I invite you to the next page, it is properly written. That is on page 16.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, item numbered 3(iv). So, Table, to avoid inconsistency, please take note and do the correct thing.

Yes, page 16...17—

Yes, Dr Kabiru Mahama?

Dr Abdul Kabiru Tiah Mahama: Mr Speaker, with your indulgence, I just want to note a minor issue on page 12.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Oh! you are taking us back to page 12?

Dr Mahama: With your indulgence, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Please do.

Dr Mahama: It is a minor one. The name “Tiah” is spelt with an “h”. And just to ensure consistency between the *Official Report* which captures the name rightly and the *Votes and Proceedings*—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: You are right. Table, take note of the correct spelling of the name.

Hon Members, in the absence of any further corrections, the *Votes and Proceedings* of Tuesday, 8th July, 2025 is hereby adopted as the true record of proceedings.

Hon Members, *Official Report* of Friday, 27th June, 2025.

Yes, Prof Kingsley Nyarko?

[Laughter]

Prof Nyarko: Mr First Deputy Speaker, Bernard Ahiafor— [Laughter]— my very good Friend.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, we are good Friends. People do not know.

Prof Nyarko: Mr Speaker, with respect, yesterday we corrected two *Official Reports*. The one you mentioned was also corrected. We did 26th and 27th, so they were done. I remember I effected changes on two of them.

Thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Prof Nyarko, we are most grateful for this insightful information. I recall that we corrected the two. Thank you very much.

Prof Nyarko: Thank you, my good Friend.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, what we have in the system is 3rd July, 2025 and 7th July, 2025. Can we comfortably take them?

Yes?

Prof Nyarko: Mr Speaker, what was sent to us that I saw this morning was 1st July, 2025. So, we have 1st July, 2025; 2nd July, 2025; and 3rd July, 2025. So, I think that we need to look at 1st of July.

Thank you. So, if it pleases you, we have the 1st July, 2025, minor correction to be made.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Well, Hon Members, I think we can put our House together and take these tomorrow. Do I have the support of the House?

Prof Nyarko: Yes, please.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Majority Chief Whip?

Mr Rockson-Nelson Etse Kwami Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, that is so.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Most grateful. The next item on the Order Paper is item numbered 6, Urgent Questions.

Yes, Majority Chief Whip?

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, in consonance with the Conclave discussions, some guide will come from you regarding the duration and the number of follow-ups. So, Mr Speaker, the Hon Minister for the Interior is ready to answer the Questions. If we may take those that are standing in his name.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well. Hon Members, the Minister responsible for the Interior has been scheduled to come and respond to Questions. He is in the Chamber and ready to respond to those Questions. May I humbly ask the Hon Minister to take his designated seat as we proceed with the item numbered 6(a). The Urgent Question is standing in the name of Hon Rev John Ntim Fordjour, Member of Parliament for Assin South.

Hon Member, you have the floor.

URGENT QUESTIONS

MINISTRY OF THE INTERIOR

Re-classification of Narcotics Control Commission as a Security and Intelligence Agency

Rev John Ntim Fordjour (NPP — Assin South): Thank you, Mr Speaker. I

beg to ask the Minister for the Interior what steps the Ministry is taking to re-classify Narcotics Control Commission as a Security and Intelligence Agency, given their crucial and sensitive mandate as a drug enforcement agency.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Minister?

Minister for the Interior (Alhaji Mohammed-Mubarak Muntaka) (MP): Thank you very much, Mr Speaker. The Ministry firmly acknowledges the critical and sensitive role of the Narcotics Control Commission in combating illicit drug trafficking and transnational crime, especially in contemporary landscapes where drug trafficking syndicates are more sophisticated and globally networked.

Mr Speaker, during my working visit to the Narcotics Control Commission on 27th February, 2025, I underscored the Commission's indispensable function as not just a regulatory body but an essential frontline law enforcement agency.

Considering the robust mandate and powers conferred on the Narcotics Control Commission in performance of its functions in accordance with the provisions of the Narcotics Control Commission Act 2020 (Act 1019), the exclusion of the Narcotics Control Commission from the Security and Intelligence Agency Act 2020 (Act 1030) could only be an oversight that must be urgently corrected.

Therefore, as the Security and Intelligence Agency Act 2020 (Act 1030) is being reviewed, the Narcotics Control Commission cannot be left on the periphery. Hence, the need for the reclassification of the Narcotics Control Commission as a security agency whose inclusion into the Security and Intelligence Agency Act is not a matter of convenience but one that is regarded as a national security imperative.

Consequently, as the Sector Minister, I have made essential recommendations for the Narcotics Control Commission to be considered as part of the proposed amendment to the provisions in the Narcotics Control Commission Act 2020 (Act 1019) to be in tandem with provisions in the Security and Intelligence Agency Act under review, and in line with international best practices.

Additionally, similar recommendations have been made to the Constitutional Review Committee to have Narcotics Control Commission explicitly cited in the Constitution as a state security agency. The primacy of this agenda is key to the realisation of the mandate of the agency. Unfortunately, the current exclusion undermines its operational capacity, especially in confronting increasingly sophisticated drug networks.

However, the effectiveness of the Narcotics Control Commission hinges on the entity being fully integrated into the national security architecture without delay. Mr Speaker, I can assure that we are working on this.

Thank you very much.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Any supplementary question?

3.48 p.m.

Rev Fordjour: Mr Speaker, I rise to thank the Minister for the Interior for the magnanimity in taking steps to consider the review of the (Act 1030) which seeks to overhaul the National Security architecture and recognising the importance of including Narcotics Control Commission or reclassifying Narcotics Control as a security and intelligence agency and conceding that it was an oversight for them to be excluded from being classified. But while I commend the Minister for that —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, you are clearly out of order. In Order 88(7), you cannot address — you can thank the Minister in a simple language.

Rev Fordjour: Mr Speaker, thank you for your guidance. I thank you and the Hon Minister and also to urge the Minister that, while waiting for the overhaul of (Act 1030), may he consider applying for the reclassification for the inclusion of Narcotics Control Commission into the National Security and Intelligence Agency.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, let us proceed to the Question numbered 6(b), also standing in the name of Rev John Ntim Fordjour, Member of Parliament for Assin South.

Please, you have the floor.

Rev Fordjour: Mr Speaker, with the greatest of respect —

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, I think following the number of Questions we have, we had agreed that we will limit ourselves to one follow-up and I have followed the Member who had asked the Question and he was just about asking the limited follow-up that he had; just one follow-up.

Mr Speaker, you appeared to have truncated that. May I appeal that you allow him to ask the only follow-up that he has.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Chief Whip, you the Leaders must guide me to do business in the House. Standing Order 88(7), and I read:

A Member, in asking a Question, shall not

- a) address the House;
- b) raise any argument; or
- c) offer an opinion.

So, whatever needed to be done is not in the ambit of the Member asking the Question. So, strictly speaking, when you pose a Question, as stated in the Order Paper, you are entitled to a supplementary question and a supplementary question must not be addressing the House; must not raise any argument and must not offer an opinion. So, by the Rules, if an Hon Member has

an opinion to offer, probably, they may have to engage the Minister.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, yes, with respect to you, I do not think this is a matter we should belabour. The practice in this House, — Oftentimes, Colleagues have stood offensive of Order 88(7).

Mr Speaker, by your guidance and wisdom, you have often guided Colleagues to be mindful of that. On many occasions, we even urge Members to either rephrase the question to be in line with the Orders. So, may I pray you that the Colleague be given the opportunity, with the greatest respect.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: With the greatest respect to Members, the first thing that I told the Hon Member is that he was violating Order 88(7). That should have prompted the Member to ask a question, rather than doing a narration. But constantly, he refused to take a cue. That is why I am moving to the next Question, also standing in his name.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: He will take a cue. So, may we revert to the first — And then he can ask his supplementary question.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So, strictly, supplementary question. So, take a cue.

Rev Fordjour: Mr Speaker, I rise to ask the Minister the is taking to apply for reclassification of Narcotics Control Commission as a security and

intelligence agency, pending the overhaul of Act 1030.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Minister?

Alhaji Muntaka: Mr Speaker, because this is embedded in Article 83 of our Constitution, it makes it a bit difficult if we do not get the Constitution itself amended. But the steps we have taken are that, I have gone to the National Security Council and I have made a case for Narcotics Control Commission Director-General to be allowed to sit in as an observer. So that he will participate in the National Security meetings as such. Also, we have taken steps to ensure that at the Regional Security Council, they also sit as ex-officio, the same with the District Security Council, pending the amendment to the Act and getting the Constitution rightly amended.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, let us move to the Question numbered 6(b), also standing in the name of Rev John Ntim Fordjour, Member of Parliament for Assin South.

You have the floor.

Steps to Procure and Install the Narcotics Detection Scanners

Rev John Ntim Fordjour (NPP — Assin South): Mr Speaker, I beg to ask the Minister for the Interior, what steps the Ministry is taking to procure and install Narcotics Detection Scanners at all critical and required checkpoints at the airports and cargo sections to replace

the broken-down scanners to ensure effective narcotics control.

Alhaji Muntaka: Mr Speaker, body and baggage scanners are vital tools in the frontline operations of the Narcotics Control Commission, particularly at the airport, where the concealment of narcotic substances has become increasingly sophisticated. Unfortunately, the current state of the broken-down scanner at the key airport and cargo checkpoints significantly hampers effective narcotics detection and undermines national and international security efforts.

Mr Speaker, past attempts to repair the faulty scanners were unsuccessful due to severe technical challenges and the unavailability of critical components to service and operationalise the broken-down machinery. To remedy this, a cost-benefit analysis was conducted by the Ministry to determine that procuring new scanners rather than repairing obsolete equipment would be the most efficient and sustainable solution, particularly since new scanners are embedded with more robust technology that would make the detection more efficient.

Mr Speaker, recognising the urgency of this matter, the Ministry has made dedicated budgetary provision under the Security Sector Retooling Programme to procure advanced body and baggage scanners to enhance the operations of the agency at the airport. These scanners are essential not only for improving the ability of the Narcotics Control Commission to detect and intercept illicit drugs, but also for aligning Ghana's counter-narcotic efforts with

international best practices in airport security and trade facilitation.

Mr Speaker, furthermore, given the global security implications of narcotic trafficking, the Ministry, in collaboration with the Narcotics Control Commission, is actively engaging both local and international partners to mobilise additional donor support to expedite the procurement and deployment of these scanners. This intervention points to the urgency with which the Government and the Narcotics Control Commission are poised to achieving effective fights against drug trafficking at our airport, and therefore, demand the immediate replacement of outdated and non-functional scanners with modern detection technology.

3.58p.m.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Any supplementary questions?

Rev Fordjour: Mr Speaker, considering the fact that, given the broken-down scanners at the ports, narcotic substances could easily transit our ports, posing a significant risk to our collective fight to ensure zero tolerance to narcotics, when can the ports be installed, with effective and running scanners to ensure our ports do not become transit points for narcotics? Thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Minister?

Alhaji Muntaka: Mr Speaker, yes, I acknowledge the challenges and the concerns of the Hon Colleague, but the

procurement process has to be followed. What we are doing in the interim is that we are using these sniffer dogs and each time we see a substance that looks like drugs, we try to get it to the laboratories to test for confirmation or otherwise.

So yes, I know that having the scanner at the airport would have been an excellent one, but because of this challenge and having to go through the procurement process, which would delay, we are currently using sniffer dogs to enhance the tracking and search for possible drugs at the airport.

I can assure my Colleagues that as soon as funds are available, we will make sure that we procure them because it is so important, not for only narcotics cases, but for all other cases such as ones involving people who are smuggling gold and other things that are not supposed to be smuggled at the airport.

Thank you very much, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you.

We then move to Question number 6(c), standing in the name of Hon Emmanuel Kwaku Boam, the Member of Parliament for Pru East.

Yes, Majority Chief Whip?

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, the Hon Member for Pru East is a Member of his Caucus and they are presently engaged with the Ministry of Trade, Agribusiness and Industry. So may I seek your leave to ask the Member for

Kwesimintsim to ask the Question on his behalf.

Mr Speaker, I thank you for the opportunity.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, I do not know under which rules the Majority Chief Whip is asking your leave for that to be done.

Mr Speaker, you always guide us and Order 88(3) is very clear. With your permission, I read:

“(3) In the absence of the Member, any other Member so authorised may, with the prior permission of the Speaker, ask the Question.”

If the Majority Chief Whip wants to ask the Question, he should seek your leave and state that he has been authorised to ask the Question. But he cannot make that application on behalf of someone else. He can guide the Member to do the application. That is not the rule.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, my Brother Habib did not listen to me carefully. He did not.

The provision he read is not applicable in this situation because the Member did not authorise the Member for Kwesimintsim to do so. But—*[Interruption]*. Please, he did not. His application to me was to have the Question stood down so that he will rush here. But I think that given the nature of

the Business, I would like to seek the leave of Mr Speaker to get the Member for Kwesimintsim to ask the Question, so we could make progress.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Majority Chief Whip, does the Member for Kwesimintsim have the authority of the questioner?

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, I am saying that the Member is pleading with me to make an application to you to have the Question stood down so that he can rush from the engagement with the Ministry with his Caucus and be here to have the Question asked. But given the nature and the speed at which we are moving, I fear that he may not come to meet the House and the Minister to ask the Question. So, my prayer is that—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Chief Whip, I would prefer to have the Question stood down. If he is not here by the time we finish with the Urgent Questions, he must do well to authorise the Member to ask the Question.

Mr Dafeamekpor: I am so grateful, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Let us move to the Question numbered 6(d), standing in the name of Hon Prof Kingsley Nyarko, the Member of Parliament for Kwadaso. You have the floor.

Prof Kingsley Nyarko: Mr Speaker, with your indulgence, I would like to seek some amendments on the Question because I have seen some minor changes

in what I have in my hand. So, if Mr Speaker would allow, then we could do the amendments before I ask the Question. So, if we come to—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Well, I do not know the nature of the amendment and whether or not the nature of the amendment will change the intent of the Question.

Prof Nyarko: Please, it will not.

It is a typographical error. So, on the third line—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, you know the rule is that when you file a Question, sometimes the person who is going to admit the Question may advise on certain changes. So, if the amendment that you are seeking to do will not change the intent of the Question, I would advise that you proceed to ask the Question as per the Order Paper.

Investigations into the Murder of Gideon Owusu Sarpong

Prof Kingsley Nyarko (NPP—Kwadaso): Mr Speaker, I rise to ask the Minister for the Interior the current state of investigations into the murder of Gideon Owusu Sarpong, a mobile money vendor at the former onion market at Kwadaso, on 20th March, 2025 and the measures put in place to ensure the safety of “vendors and customers”.

Thank you.

4.08 p.m.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Minister?

Minister for the Interior (Alhaji Mohammed-Mubarak Muntaka) (MP): Mr Speaker, on 10th March, 2025, complainant Anze James of House Number Plot 66, Block 14 of Oforikrom, Kumasi called at the Kwadaso Police Station and reported that he could not reach out to Gideon Owusu Sarpong, a mobile money vendor, for the past two days. That when he visited his resident at Old Soldier Barracks, Kwadaso, he noticed a foul smell and swarm of houseflies surrounding the window. So, he informed the Police.

Mr Speaker, on receipt of the information, the police proceeded to the scene and found the body of the deceased, aged about 24 years, lying in a prone position on his bed with multiple wounds on his legs, left shoulder, neck and face in a pool of blood.

Mr Speaker, his legs and hands were tied with ropes at the back and his mouth covered with sellotape. The crime scene management team led by Deputy Superintendent of Police, Mr Francis Nimoo, visited the scene of the crime. The scene was processed and fingerprints impressions were lifted. Exhibits such as kitchen knife, cutlass and face cap were retrieved from the scene. The body was conveyed to the Komfo Anokye Teaching Hospital Morgue for preservation and autopsy.

On 13th March, 2025, post-mortem examination was performed on the body of the deceased by a pathologist at the Komfo Anokye Teaching Hospital, Dr Kobina Owusu Eninkura, after the body was identified by the uncle of the deceased, Rev George Opoku, in the presence of police. The cause of death was given as a strangulation B-sharp edge injury in the anterior neck, unnatural. Investigations revealed that the deceased, Gideon Owusu Sarpong, was employed by John Bright Amu as a mobile money vendor at Racecourse, Kumasi, but resident at Old Barracks, Kwadaso.

Due to the location of the business, the deceased received large sums of money from customers, especially from onion traders travelling to and from Mali, Niger and Burkina Faso. He usually closes from work at about 6 p.m. On 8th March, 2025, at about 8 p.m., the deceased returned home and when he entered his room, he was attacked by assailants who had laid ambush for him in the house.

He was stabbed multiple times with knives on his legs, left shoulder, neck, and face, after which they tied his legs and hands with a rope and robbed him of his iPhone, other phones, cash of GH¢200,000, and mobile money SIM card numbers 059-422-6749, 055-486-9150, and 024-148-0313, with e-cash amounting to over GH¢400,000. The assailants, after the attack, locked the door outside with a padlock. It has also been established that the robbers transferred cash from the phones of the deceased to other mobile money vendors, which are being traced.

On 21st March, 2025, Police intelligence led to the arrest of suspect Charles Kwame Danso, *alias* Italy, at Pankrono, Kumasi. During investigations, a caution statement was obtained. He admitted to the offence and mentioned suspects Philip Kofi Fordjour, *alias* Left Eye; Samuel Addae Mensah; and Martin Amoah, *alias* Baba Macho, as his accomplices.

Suspect Charles Kwame Danso, *alias* Italy, led Police to arrest suspect, Philip Kofi Fordjour, *alias* Left Eye; and Samuel Addae Mensah at Atimatim, Kumasi. They both denied their involvement in the offence; however, they admitted to being friends with the suspect Charles Kwame Danso and Martin Amoah *alias* Baba Macho, who is at large.

On 27th March, 2025, suspect Martin Amoah, *alias* Baba Macho, was arrested in Kpone, Tema. In his investigation caution statement, he mentioned suspect Mavis Gyasi, as one of their accomplices. On 3rd April, 2025, suspect Mavis Gyasi, was also arrested at Pankrono, Kumasi. However, she denied her involvement. Suspect Charles Kwame Danso, also known as (a.k.a.) Italy; Philip Kofi Fordjour, a.k.a. Left Eye; Samuel Addae Mensah; Martin Amoah a.k.a. Baba Macho; and Mavis Gyasi were arraigned before the Magistrate Court, Asokwa, presided over by Her Ladyship Mrs Afua Densi Asare-Kyire. Charges and facts were read and plea was not taken. Suspects were remanded into prison custody to reappear on 16th July, 2025. Meanwhile, on 17th June, 2025, the duplicate case

docket had been sent to the Office of the Attorney-General and Ministry of Justice, Kumasi, for study and advice.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Any supplementary question?

Prof Nyarko: Mr Speaker, I want to thank the Hon Minister, the Ministry of the Interior and the Ghana Police Service (GPS) for a very good job done. But I am pleading with them to expedite the process for justice to be done in favour of the departed brother who lives in the constituency.

Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: We then move to the Question numbered 6(e), standing in the name of Mr Daniel Nana Addo-Kenneth, Member of Parliament for Okere.

Mr Addo-Kenneth: Thank you, Mr Speaker. Mr Speaker, I rise to ask the Minister for Roads—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, hold it.

Hon Members, under this circumstance, let us vary the order of Questions, so that we can take the Oral Answers to Questions for the Minister for the Interior and discharge him; then, we come back to the rest of the Urgent Questions, standing in the name of other Ministers.

Hon Members, is that agreeable to the House?

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, that is so; we are in agreement.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well.

The application is to vary the order of Questions, so that we take Oral Answers to Questions, standing in the name of the Minister for the Interior and we can have him discharged. Then, we will bring in another Minister who will also answer Urgent Questions and proceed to answer the Oral Answers to Questions.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, as much as we might not have difficulty in it, the Majority Frontbench should learn how to engage us in some of these things. If we had engaged, we would not have any difficulty in doing so.

If they want to vary the order of Business to go to Oral Answers to Questions rather than continue with Urgent Questions, they should learn to engage us, so that we agree and we can have this thing flowing. But for them to just do it as if they can just say it—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Well, your point is well noted, except that is a suggestion emanating from the Chair. That is why I am asking whether we are in agreement with it.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, we have no difficulty because the Minister for the Interior is a former Leader, so we have no problem. We have

that respect for him. But the Frontbench and the Majority Chief Whip should learn how to engage us.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, with this—

Yes, Majority Chief Whip?

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, in fact, the request did not come from the Majority Frontbench. So, we are *ad idem* that the Business be varied to take Oral Answers to Questions.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well.

Hon Daniel Nana Addo-Kenneth, we will come back to Urgent Questions where you will have your turn to pose a Question to the Minister for Roads and Highways.

So, Hon Members, let us move to the Question numbered 148, the item numbered 7.

Yes, Hon Member?

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, I have the authority of the Member to stand down the Question numbered 148.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: We will take the Question numbered 169, standing in the name of Hon Frank Asiedu Bekoe, Member of Parliament for Suhum.

ORAL ANSWERS TO QUESTIONS

MINISTRY OF THE INTERIOR

State of Intercepted Alleged Counterfeit US Dollars, Cedis and Suspected Gold Bars in Sapeiman

Mr Frank Asiedu Bekoe (NPP — Suhum): Mr Speaker, I rise to ask the Minister for the Interior the state of the interception of an alleged massive haul of counterfeit US dollars, Ghana cedi notes and suspected gold bars hidden in 20-foot containers at a warehouse in Sapeiman on 9th March, 2025.

Minister for the Interior (Alhaji Muhammed-Mubarak Muntaka) (MP): Mr Speaker, in March 2025, security operatives, acting on intelligence reports, successfully intercepted suspected counterfeit US dollars and fraudulent gold bars stored in a shipping container located in the Sapeiman area.

Following established security protocols, the exhibits were securely protected. Later, in the interest of accountability, the media – an important partner in this effort – was invited to cover the story for reporting purposes.

The National Security is also collaborating with the US Embassy to confirm the authenticity of the suspected counterfeit currencies. At the same time, there is a collaboration with the Bank of Ghana and the Ghana Gold Board to confirm the authenticity of the intercepted gold bars and Ghana cedis.

Mr Speaker, it is worth mentioning that the operation was initiated following days of monitoring and tracking the *modus operandi* of the suspects.

However, on the day the swoop was conducted, the prime suspects had escaped before the security personnel arrived at the scene. Investigation is ongoing to identify the suspects and their agents and the extent of their operations.

Thank you very much, Mr Speaker.

4.18 p.m.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Any supplementary question?

Mr Bekoe: Mr Speaker, could the Hon Minister name these suspects?

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Minister, can you name the suspects?

Alhaji Muntaka: Mr Speaker, as you may know, because of the nature of the operation, it is not possible to name the suspects at this stage because we are still trying to apprehend all those involved. What I can tell the House is that the lead person is not even a Ghanaian, but we believe he has collaborators who are Ghanaians that are facilitating this kind of operation.

If he noticed and I am sure he may have some information, but where we found the containers, we have still left them in the same compound. We have only provided security men and women to guard it to make sure that we do not even temper with the content of the

container. So, he can be rest assured, once the investigation and the operations are over and we are able to apprehend all those involved, we will put up their names. Definitely, they will be before the court and their names will be known.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you very much.

Hon Members, let us move to the Question numbered 171—Yes, Hon Member?

Mr Charles Asuako Owiredue: Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr Speaker, in the Answer of the Hon Minister, he said the National Security was collaborating with the US Embassy to authenticate the currency, that is the United States dollars. I am wondering, why would the Minister want to collaborate with the US Embassy to authenticate the dollars while we have counterfeit machines in all the banks and the Bank of Ghana (BoG) also has counterfeit machines? Even *Abotsi*, using his fingertips—[*Laughter*—can tell us that this is fake or genuine. Why would he want to waste time since March, to hear from the US Embassy before he continues?

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Minister, you have the floor.

Alhaji Muntaka: Mr Speaker, well, let me say here and now, and emphatically, that in fact, they wrote to us wanting to be part of it. Because it was US dollars, they wanted to be sure of the routes and how these gentlemen get to

even do what they do. So, they wrote to us wanting to be part of the operation. That is why I told the House that when it came to the issue of the counterfeiting, our reliance was on the Bank of Ghana and for the gold, the Ghana Gold Board (GoldBod). But the US Embassy invited themselves in by writing to us that once the US dollar has been mentioned, they want to be part of it.

As the Hon Member may know, because I know he is a former Ambassador, when it comes to the US dollar, the United States of America does not joke with that currency. Anywhere in this world where the currency could be affected, they want to be there to protect their currency. That is why they came in. It is not because we had doubts and we believed that they were the only institution that could authenticate it. No. In fact, they wrote and wanted to be part of it because they wanted to be part of the investigation so that if there is a syndicate that is related to their citizens, they will be able to break the syndicate.

Thank you very much, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, we move to the Question numbered 171 which stands in the name of Mr Frank Asiedu Bekoe, Member of Parliament for Suhum.

Update on Arrests on Alleged Illicit Drugs on the Cape Coast — Takoradi Road

Mr Frank Asiedu Bekoe (NPP — Suhum): Mr Speaker, I beg to ask the Minister for the Interior to provide an

update on arrests made on 4th March, 2025 on the Cape Coast to Takoradi Highway in respect of some substances alleged to be illicit drugs.

Alhaji Muntaka: Mr Speaker, in March 2025, state security agencies conducted intelligence-led operations across the Central and Western Regions, resulting in the interception of substances suspected to be cocaine weighing 3,313 kilograms and the arrest of some individuals.

Following comprehensive investigations and laboratory testing that confirmed the substances as cocaine, two suspects were arraigned before court and subsequently granted bail. Scientists from the Ghana Standards Authority (GSA) were subsequently invited to conduct additional testing on the substances after which the court issued an order for the destruction of the seized substances. The destruction was subsequently carried out on 20th June, 2025 at Bundase in the Greater Accra Region.

It must be mentioned that apart from the driver and his assistant, four other individuals were subsequently arrested and granted bail. Two prime suspects are, however, at large. Efforts are ongoing to arrest them. The next court hearing on the matter is scheduled to take place on 24th July, 2025.

Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Any supplementary question?

Mr Bekoe: Mr Speaker, I want to appreciate from the Hon Minister who are these suspects and are they politically exposed?

Alhaji Muntaka: Mr Speaker, like I rightly said, two persons that we suspect are the lead persons are at large. It is the reason we do not put up their names. Anyone who has worked within the security area will tell you that once you have not finished apprehending all the suspects, you do not put up their names, because the moment you put up their names, you are giving others the opportunity to escape. But like I said, those that we have arrested have been put before court, they have got a bail and the next court hearing is on 24th July, 2025.

Maybe, I know he may want to ask who and who have been put before the court. That is public record and I necessarily do not need to mention it. If he is truly interested, they are listed, but he asked if they are politically exposed? What I know, for certain, is that none of them is a Member of Parliament (MP) or a Minister or a former MP or a relation to any of these people.

But when he asks if they are exposed, we may not be able to tell. Until we finish the investigation and get those that have absconded, then we may try to say that they are linked to this person or that person. For now, I can assure him that all those we have in hand, none is a Member of Parliament or a former MP or a Minister or a former Minister or a known party activist.

Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Dr Abdul Kabiru Tiah Mahama:
Thank you very much, Mr Speaker.

Mr Speaker, I would like to find out from the Hon Minister, why is it that a suspect wanted by the police for investigation cannot be presented to the public to aid in the arrest of such a person.

Alhaji Muntaka: Mr Speaker, once again, I would like to repeat that once we have not concluded investigations, when we provide names, we are providing leads. When we are done with investigations, we would even publish them as wanted because now, we are done and we are certain that this is the complete syndicate or those that we are looking for.

We can then even advertise that these are wanted individuals. We can use Interpol, which our country is a member, to even track them if we know where they are. But at the time that some of them are at large, putting out names is not useful; we will jeopardise the investigation. But once it is done, they are sometimes even put on the wanted list and on the Interpol list for tracking and possible arrests wherever they may find themselves in the world. We are not done with the investigations.

And we always want to believe that these are not just mere persons who do these things. Sometimes, the connivance is with people who are even very close to the enforcement agencies. That is why we do not provide the names when we

are not done with investigation. Other than that, sometimes, in the media, we see that the police say that somebody is wanted for this crime or that crime. It is because as at then, they have finished and they are certain that this is the closed circuit.

But when you are not done with that, you do not put out the names, because when you do that, you are compromising your operations.

4.28 p.m.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Mr Nyindam, you have the floor.

Mr Matthew Nyindam: Mr Speaker, according to the Minister, the investigations and prosecutions are still ongoing. And per the answer, on 24th of this month, the case will be heard again. But by reading the Answers he provided, he said “those substances have been destroyed” after testing. So, I do not know how that can be done.

I want to find out from him what evidence they are now going to use to prosecute.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Minister?

Alhaji Muntaka: Mr Speaker, let me encourage my Hon Colleagues to sometimes learn the rules on how they destroy these things. On our own, we can never take the drugs and go and destroy them; we have to secure a court order.

So, when you arrest and it has been tested, you do a second test and if it is confirmed, you now notify the court that it has been confirmed. So, if for example, you are looking for Hon Nyindam and it is confirmed that it is cocaine, it is no longer an issue. It is when you are investigating, and you are not certain whether it is cocaine or not, that is when you keep it. But once you confirm — because remember storage is a problem and you do not want to keep it.

We have had a situation in this country where drugs that have been stored got lost. So, the moment you confirm that it is substance, you go to court and get authorisation so that you destroy it; because it is no longer an issue in the investigation. So in this instance, that is it. It has been confirmed by the court and we already have about six people in hand. So, the court gave us authorisation to destroy it and we did that, I think on the 20th of June.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Member? This may be the last supplementary question.

Mr Vincent Ekow Assafuah: Mr Speaker, I think the question that Mr Nyindam was asking is the evidence of the destruction. Is it possible that he can provide evidence of the destruction or the people that witnessed that destruction? I think that is what he wanted to find out.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, we all heard the question posed by Mr Nyindam very clearly. His view was that once the people are not tried,

some are at large, why should we destroy the evidence? And the Minister has answered that question to the effect that it has been tested and certificated and the court order was to destroy it.

We live in a country where exhibits were lost. So, they do not want to keep these exhibits for long. So, I think the question has been answered for Mr Nyindam.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes? Hon Minority Chief Whip, you have the floor.

Mr Frank Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, let me attempt not to stand in breach of Order 88 (7). The revelations given by the Minister is quite interesting. Is it the case that the order from the court was based on application from the Ministry, and there is evidence of the court order that prescribed the destruction of — in this context, we can call it cocaine, because the Minister has confirmed that the substance was confirmed as cocaine. Would the Minister be able to give us these further details?

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Minister?

Alhaji Muntaka: Mr Speaker, yes, it was done publicly. In fact, the day and time was even announced and the media covered it. I want to believe that if we google now, we should find it because the destruction was done publicly. But usually, this is what normally happens; we have a number of substances such as Indian hemp and others, and we keep saving. Now, when we secure a court

order to destroy them, we put them together.

So, for example, we go and confirm everything and a court order is given for destruction, we then announce it to the public and take the media along. Most of the time, when we are doing this, our international partners are interested and they also come to observe and ensure that it is truly destroyed and destroyed properly.

So, I want to believe that if we google, we will even find evidence of the video. But if it is the will of the House, why not? I can provide some of the videos for you. The Director-General is behind me and I am sure he may even be interested in sending some of the videos through *WhatsApp* which I would be able to send to the Hon Minority Leadership immediately through *WhatsApp*.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, can we end the supplementary with Mr Nyindam based on our agreement?

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, I would like to find out from the Minister if it will please him to make available to us a copy of the court order for the destruction of the said substance, so that we can —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, the law that this House passed, stipulates how these exhibits are supposed to be destroyed. Hon Minister, they want you to produce the order.

Alhaji Muntaka: Mr Speaker, I can assure the leadership and the Table

Office, I am going to *WhatsApp* the court order to them immediately. I have just asked that they scan and send it to me so that I send it to you. I do not even need to go out and later bring it. So, when I *WhatsApp* it to the Table Office, they will print and make copies for them.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, do you have a supplementary question?

Mr Rockson-Nelson Etse Kwami Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, I am wondering, if they want the Hon Minister to lay his phone, because he needs to get the order for them, so he would not do that — and the ashes — *[Laughter]*

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Majority Leader?

Mr Mahama Ayariga: Mr Speaker, I want to find out from the Minister whether next time, when they are burning it, he would like to invite some of the Members on that Side, so that they can inhale the smoke — *[Laughter]*

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Majority Leader, your question is not emanating from the Answer nor the question posed.

Ms Patricia Appiagyei: Mr Speaker, on a more serious note, I have been wondering, there is a case where we have had an incident where an exhibit got lost. Would it be wrong for the Minister to prescribe a much safer way of keeping these exhibits? I think we should be

looking at that because the destruction is raising all kinds of doubts.

4.38 p.m.

Alhaji Muntaka: Mr Speaker, I can assure my Colleague that the law has made adequate provision as to how we keep them. Each time we have them, for example, we have insisted that we do not keep these exhibits for long, for the possibility of individuals ever thinking of tampering with them. We have exhibits room where each day when there are activities, we open and then keep for safekeeping.

Now, if you keep so many of them there, and it is tampered with, it becomes a problem. Yes, there are cameras, there are all the things —if we have to open, all the protocols are there. But remember, we are dealing with human beings. So, our practice is that we do not let it stay for long. We take the necessary steps, go to court, get the court order, and then it gets escorted in the glaring eye of the public. We invite the media, the international partners —.

There is a United Nations organisation that is interested in what we call Drugs and Crime and they come to observe. It includes the United Nations Development Programme (UNDP), International Criminal Police Organization (INTERPOL), and a lot of others. We invite all of them to come and see what the court order is and the substances are checked individually.

It is checked. So, for example, this one that we said 3,313 kilos, it will be

checked that truly that is a 3,313 kilo. All of them will be checked before the destruction. So, there is a law governing how it is done.

So, I can assure you that it is not done in the night, it is not done in secrecy, it is not done in a back room somewhere, it is done in the open where everyone who wish to be there is there and like the Majority Leader suggested, maybe the next time we are going to do destruction, Mr Speaker, with your permission, we could invite some Members of Parliament to come and observe the process so that they can appreciate what goes through destruction.

Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you. The Question numbered 172, standing in the name of Hon Frank Asiedu Bekoe.

Hon Member, you have the floor.

Current Status of the Implementation of the National Security Strategy by H. E. Nana Addo Dankwa Akufo-Addo

Mr Frank Asiedu Bekoe (NPP — Suhum): Mr Speaker, I beg to ask the Minister for Interior the current status of the implementation of the National Security Strategy outlined by H. E. Nana Addo Dankwa Akufo-Addo in the year 2020.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Minister?

Alhaji Muntaka: Thank you very much, Mr Speaker.

Mr Speaker, in June 2021, Ghana launched its National Security Strategy 2020 under the theme “A Secure and Prosperous Ghana with Regional, Continental and Global Reach and Influence.” Despite being designated as a 2020 document, it was officially unveiled in 2021 to serve as the guiding framework for Ghana’s security agencies and their operations.

The strategy included provisions for an annexure requiring various stakeholder agencies to develop complementary mini-strategies aligned with the overarching document. The prescribed timeline for these developments ranged from March 2021 to June 2021. However, at the time of the strategy’s launch, the deadlines for most agencies to prepare their mini-strategies had already passed. The strategy mandates the establishment of a review committee to evaluate and update the document every four years, indicating that the first comprehensive review was due in 2024.

Mr Speaker, given the evolving global, regional, sub-regional, and national security landscape, a comprehensive review is essential to ensure effective implementation and monitoring of Ghana’s security objectives. In response to this need, the national security framework remains relevant, responsive, and aligned with contemporary security.

Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Any further question?

Mr Bekoe: Yes, I would like to appreciate from the Minister if the Ministry will consider implementing the strategy and reviewing it as time goes on.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Minister?

Alhaji Muntaka: Mr Speaker, yes, I can assure my Colleague, it is the guiding principle now and we have been using it to guide most of our operations. Yes, like I said, looking at the season of time, we need to come up with a review and we are in the process of doing that but we are currently using the strategy to implement most of the things that we are embarking on. Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, let us move back to the Question numbered 148, standing in the name of Ms Shirley Kyei, Atwima Nwabiagya South.

Yes?

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Hon Habib made an earlier application to stand down that particular Question.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes. So, the earlier ruling that I had given is that if at the time we are finishing with the Minister, the Member who posed the Question is not in, then we will take the appropriate decision.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, with all due respect, that earlier directive was in respect of the Hon—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, it is applicable for this one and because we are now on normal Questions before we move to Urgent Questions, that is why I am calling on the Question.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, then our response is that with your leave, we want Question number 148 stood down.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, that is why I am saying that the Question can only be stood down, so long as we have other Questions for the Minister. But as we speak now, apart from the Question numbered 148 and the Urgent Question numbered (c), we have no further Question for the Minister and these are the two Questions stood down. So, should we take a decision on the two?

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, yes, my indications are that Question number 148 will be withdrawn, then the Question numbered 6(c), which was stood down in the name of Hon Boam is here. So, we may have to vary, go back to Urgent Questions, so he can ask his Question so that the Minister can answer.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well. So, the Question numbered 148 is hereby withdrawn.

Mr Dafeamekpor: It is accordingly withdrawn, Mr Speaker. I thank you for the opportunity.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: The Question numbered 6(c), Hon Member, you have the floor.

URGENT QUESTION

MINISTRY OF THE INTERIOR

Steps Taken to Curb Armed Robbery Attacks Along Ejura-Yeji Highway

Mr Emmanuel Kwaku Boam (NDC — Pre East): Thank you very much, Mr Speaker. I beg to ask the Minister for the Interior; the concrete steps the Ministry is taking to curb armed robbery attacks and violent attacks on the Ejura-Yeji Highway.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Minister, you have the floor.

Minister for the Interior (Alhaji Mohammed-Mubarak Muntaka) (MP): Thank you, Mr Speaker. I wish to state that the Asante Regional North is one of the newly created Regions, which was commissioned on the 18th July, 2023. Below are the activities undertaken with some challenges faced. Ejura-Yeji and Sekyeredumase-Nkoranza stretch.

Mr Speaker, currently Ejura command operates one snap checkpoint at Kasei, a barrier at Droma-Kuma with one Formed Police Unit (FPU) patrol team between Kasei and Droma-Kuma on the Ejura-Yeji stretch. The command also plans to set up additional snap checkpoints at Ejura Nkwanta, Krontihene junction and Prison junction to be supported by a patrol team in the Ejura-Yeji stretch of

the road. We have also deployed 50 police officers, well trained on highway robbery, on the Yeji-Atebubu stretch and provided an additional pickup vehicle to support the operations.

Mr Speaker, the challenges that we have are additional manpower and vehicles that are needed on the Ejura-Yeji stretch and on the Ejura-Nkoranza stretch. Additional snap checks are also needed and two patrol teams are also being considered at Ebuem and Bayere Nkwanta on the Ejura Nkoranza road and another for Sekyeredumase-Nkoranza and Sekyeredumase-Anyinaso Boamah road.

Mr Speaker, Mampong-Ejura stretch, Mampong District operates two snap checkpoints at Santaso Bridge, Teak Forest and a barrier at Boantem with FPU patrol teams at Adididwa-Ejura Strap. The command also plans to build a post around Santaso Bridge and Teak Forest to be supported with a vehicle to operate around the clock. There is a weak bridge at Santaso on the Mampong-Abuontem stretch leaving drivers with no choice but to slow down.

The construction of this will go a long way to reduce the robbery incident on this stretch.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, before taking the supplementary question, let me acknowledge the presence of students from Esikam Presbyterian Basic School. They are led by Addey Priscilla, headmistress. They are from Abuakwa South and they are 62 in number.

[Students from Esikam Presbyterian Basic School were acknowledged]

4.48 p.m.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: We also have Twifo Praso Senior High School led by David Tefe, teacher and they are from Twifo Atti Morkwa. They are 105 in number.

[Students from Twifo Praso Senior High School were acknowledged]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Then we have Akenten Appiah-Menka University of Skills Training and Entrepreneurial Development led by Silvanus Fiifi Brookman Kofie, patron. They are from Kwadaso. Is the Member of Parliament for Kwadaso here? They are 68 in number. May you have a fruitful visit to Parliament of Ghana. Thank you for coming.

[Students from Akenten Appiah-Menka University of Skills Training and Entrepreneurial Development were acknowledged]

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, any supplementary question?

Mr Boam: Mr Speaker, I want to thank the Hon Minister for the response to the Question, but I stand here with a heavy heart, trying to wish a businessman who lost his life just last Sunday after coming for normal business—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, respect the Rules. You either

ask a supplementary question or you humbly resume your seat — Hon Members, we owe fidelity to the Rules. So, if you do not have any supplementary question, kindly resume your seat.

Mr Boam: Mr Speaker, thank you. For now, no supplementary question.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you very much. Hon Members, may I thank the Minister for attending upon the House to answer Questions. Hon Minister, you are hereby discharged.

We move to the Urgent Question numbered (e). Minister for Roads and Highways, may you kindly take your designated seat. Hon Members, Question 6(e), standing in the name of Mr Daniel Nana Addo-Kenneth, Member of Parliament for Okere.

Hon Member, you now have the floor.

MINISTRY OF ROADS AND HIGHWAYS

Measures to Reduce the Rampant Accidents on Some Roads in Okere Constituency

Mr Daniel Nana Addo-Kenneth (NPP — Okere): Mr Speaker, I beg to ask the Minister for Roads and Highways, the urgent safety measures being implemented to reduce the rampant occurrence of accidents on the Adukrom-Aseseeso-Akuni-Trom Junction Road and Adukrom-Nkurakan Road particularly the Adukrom-Bepoase-Asenema-Okarakwodwo-

Junction and Kobokobo-Onyamebekyere-Aboma Junction Section.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Minister?

Minister for Roads and Highways (Mr Kwame Govers Agbodza): Mr Speaker, the Nkurakan-Adukrom-Trom Junction Road, R42, is a vital regional road in the Eastern Region, connecting several towns and serving as a link between major transportation routes. It is part of a road network which supports the north-south movement across the Volta and Eastern Regions. The project was awarded under the contract titled Reconstruction of Nkurakan -Adukrom-Trom Junction Road.

The project commenced on 23rd December, 2020 for completion by 18th July, 2024. The project is substantially completed and is in defect liability period. Stage 5 of the Road Safety Audit post-opening stage is being carried out to monitor and evaluate the road's performance against the features that have been implemented. This includes conducting accident investigation analysis to identify blind spots and propose further safety measures to reduce accidents.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Do you have any supplementary question?

Mr Addo-Kenneth: Mr Speaker, the Minister indicated that evaluation is being done. I would like to ask the Minister, in the interim, what key measures can he put in place? Because

within this first quarter, we have had about 66 casualties and 15 deaths on that road. Knowing how hilly the place is with very sharp curbs, can the Minister propose some immediate step guard measures while this safety evaluation is being done?

Mr Agbodza: Mr Speaker, I agree with my Colleague, though the irony is that this road was previously in a very bad state. It has been done to a very high level of quality. The road looks very good and unfortunately, motorists are unable to control themselves in terms of adhering to the speed limits.

So, we are working with the Motor Transport and Traffic Directorate (MTTD) to make sure that the speed limits that apply to this road are fully implemented while the Ministry takes time to implement further speed control measures on the road to make sure we limit the carnage on the road. I agree with him that we ought to speed up the interventions that will make sure that the accidents reduce, but I will work with him.

The difficulty is that we complain when the roads are in bad state, and then when they are done to the standard we want, then it becomes another danger. So, I think it is purely the issue of motorists adhering to the speed limits that have been prescribed for these kinds of roads.

Mr Speaker, we are basically going to build several speed ramps on the road just to reduce the effect we want people to have on the road, that is to travel

within reasonable time. So, we will continue to work with the MTTD and also implement the rest of the safety features on the road.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you very much. The Question numbered 6(f), standing in the name of Hon Emmanuel Kweku Boam, Member of Parliament for Pru East. You have the floor. That Question is for Ministry of Transport. So, Hon Members, let us vary the order of Questions and take the rest of the Questions for the Minister for Roads and Highways, as we did in the case of the Minister for the Interior, so that we can discharge him for the Minister for Transport to take his turn.

Yes?

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, I think we can proceed.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well. So, the Question numbered 187, Mr Mumuni Muhammed Nurideen.

Alhaji Mumuni: Mr Speaker, I beg to ask the Minister for Roads and Highways when the construction of the following roads in Nalerigu-Gambaga will be completed; Nalerigu-Sakogu-Nakpanduri-Bunkprugu roads —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, you have not fully asked the Question on the Order Paper. May you do so?

Alhaji Mumuni: Mr Speaker, I beg to ask the Minister for Roads and Highways when the construction of the Nalerigu-

Sakogu-Nakpanduri-Bunkprugu roads, awarded by the previous government, that is the Nana Addo-Bawumia-led administration, will be completed?

4.58 p.m.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, take a cue. You are to read the question; you do not add and you do not subtract.

Alhaji Mumuni: Mr Speaker, I have not added anything. The only thing I added was the “Nana Addo-Bawumia”.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So, from your Question, tell me where “Nana Addo-Bawumia” is mentioned.

Alhaji Mumuni: Mr Speaker, thank you very much.

If I say the previous Government alone without adding the Nana Addo-Bawumia, the previous Government could mean the Rawlings Government.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Why did you not add Nana Addo-Bawumia to the Question at the time you were filing it?

Hon Member, we are applying the Rules. You can forfeit the right to ask the Question.

ORAL ANSWERS TO QUESTIONS

MINISTRY OF ROADS AND HIGHWAYS

Completion of Nalerigu-Sakogu-Nakpanduri-Bunkpurugu Road

Alhaji Nurideen Muhammed Mumuni (NPP — Nalerigu/Gambaga): Mr Speaker, I will take the Question again.

Mr Speaker, I rise to ask the Minister for Roads and Highways when the construction of Nalerigu-Sakogu-Nakpanduri-Bunkpurugu Roads awarded by the previous Government would be completed.

Thank you very much.

Minister for Roads and Highways (Mr Kwame Govers Agbodza) (MP): Mr Speaker, the Nalerigu-Sakogu-Nakpambu-Bunkpurugu Road,

Background

The road is a section of the IR11 highway that runs through the North East, Upper East and Upper West Regions. It is located within the Gambaga Municipality and the Bunkpurugu District of the North East Region. The length is 68km.

Current Programme

The Nalerigu - Sakogu - Nakpanduri - Bunkpurugu Road has been awarded in three (3) Lots as follows:

- a) Upgrading of Nalerigu-Nakpanduri Road (km 0.0-25.8) Lot 1
- b) Resealing of Nakpanduri-Bende Road (km 0.0-27.0)- Lot 2
- c) Upgrading of Bende-Bunkpurugu Road (km 0.0-15.2) Lot 3

Upgrading of Nalerigu-Nakpanduri Road (km 0.0-25.8) Lot 1

The contract commenced on 29th November, 2024, just a few days before the election, for completion by 28th November, 2026. The progress of works is estimated at 17 per cent physical completion. The contractor is on site and works are progressing steadily.

Resealing of Nakpanduri-Bende Road (km 0.0-27.0)- Lot 2

The contract commenced on 12th December, 2024, after the election, for completion by 11th December, 2026. The contractor is yet to mobilise to site.

Upgrading of Bende-Bunkpurugu Road (km 0.0-15.2) Lot 3

The contract commenced on 12th December, 2024, once again, after the election, for completion by 11th December, 2026. The progress of works is estimated at 19 per cent physical completion. The contractor is on site and works are progressing steadily.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Any supplementary questions?

Alhaji Mumuni: Hon Minister, if you look at this particular road, it starts at Nalerigu, a popular point called Nyankulga. Currently, the bridge at Nyankulga is using a temporary steel.

I want to find out; is the construction of a permanent bridge at Nyankulga part of the project?

Mr Agbodza: Mr Speaker, the Question was clear: “To ask the Minister for Roads and Highways when the Nalerigu-Sakogu-Nakpambu-Bunkpurugu road awarded by the previous Government will be completed”.

He is now talking about a specific scope within or without the project. I am unaware of a temporary bridge that needed to be replaced. If the question were to tell me about a scope of works, I would have confirmed whether that particular bridge is part of the project or not.

So, I am unable to comment on whether the temporary bridge will be replaced or not. But I can only assume that, since the bridge is on that stretch, it would have been worked on as part of this project.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, for the purposes of all of us taking a cue, Order 88(2) says that:

“The Member called shall rise and ask the Question that stands in the name of the Member on the Order Paper”.

That is why you must read the Question on the Order Paper. You do not have a right to choose to leave part of the Question or now introduce other issues into the Question. So, we should be guided accordingly.

Also, for supplementary question, Order 89 concluded by saying that a supplementary question shall not introduce a matter not included in the original Question.

So, Hon Member, be guided by these two Rules accordingly.

Let us move to the Question number 204, standing in the name of Hon Robert Wisdom Cudjoe, Member of Parliament for Prestea Huni-Valley.

Status of the Bogoso Nsu-Siding Huni Valley Road

Mr Robert Wisdom Cudjoe (NDC — Prestea Huni-Valley): Mr Speaker, I rise to ask the Minister for Roads and Highways the status of the Bogoso Nsu-Siding Huni Valley Road.

Mr Agbodza: Mr Speaker,

Background

The Bogoso - Nsu-Siding - Huni Valley Road (26km) is in the Prestea-Huni Valley Municipality of the Western Region. The road forms part of the Regional Road R121.

Current Programme

The Bogoso – Nsu-Siding – Huni Valley Road has been awarded on contract under the title: **“Upgrading of Bogoso – Nsu-Siding – Huni Valley Road (Km 0.0-26.0) – Lot 4”**.

Works commenced on 19th March, 2020 for completion by 19th September, 2022. Huni Valley Town Roads was packaged as a Variation Order under the **“Upgrading of Bogoso - Nsu-Siding – Huni Valley Road (Km 0.0-26.0) – Lot 4”**.

Physical Progress of work is estimated at 37.6 per cent. The contractor is currently not on site due to delayed payment for work done. Steps are being taken to get the contractor back to site to complete the outstanding works.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Any supplementary?

Mr Cudjoe: Mr Speaker, may I be privileged to have some of the steps taken because this project has been abandoned for almost three years now?

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Let us move to Question numbered—

Yes, Hon Member?

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, the Minister, before this House, tells us that steps are being taken to ensure that the contractor gets back to site. That is a very major road. He also says that it is as a result of some non-payment.

May I know from him whether that road is part of the priority for payment in respect of what has been released?

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Well, this should be a very fresh Question and Hon Minority Leader, let me also remind you that, at Conclave, it was agreed that we will not take supplementary questions on constituency-specific Questions.

So, let us proceed to the Question number 205.

Osahen Afenyo-Markin: Mr Speaker, with respect, that is correct. But, in this House, we rely on public records and it is not only us but the interest of the public. If we have the Minister sharing with us a critical information to the effect that steps are being taken and also makes a disclosure that the delay is as a result of non-payment, I believe that it necessarily follows that the members of the public, especially users of that stretch of the road—A lot of trucks use that stretch of the road; I have been in that area before and I know the traffic levels.

I only want to know from the Minister whether, as part of the steps, he is prioritising the payment. He was very general. But if you do not want him to answer, that is all right.

5.08 p.m.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Minority Leader, the Question is on the status, but you are talking about steps.

By the Rules, this question is overruled.

Hon Members, the Question numbered 205 which stands in the name of Mr Dapaah Elvis Osei Mensah, Member of Parliament for Ahafo Ano South West.

Hon Member, you have the floor.

Mr Onyina-Acheampong: Mr Speaker, I rise under Order 88(3) and with the authorisation of Mr Dapaah Elvis Osei Mensah and your permission, I will proceed to ask the Question.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Please, ask the Question.

Mr Onyina-Acheampong: Mr Speaker, thank you.

Update on Re-Awarding Bitumen Surfacing of Mpasaaso No. 2 to Asuorkor Feeder Road

Mr Akwasi Gyamfi Onyina-Acheampong on behalf of Mr Dapaah Elvis Osei Mensah (NPP — Ahafo Ano South West): Mr Speaker, I beg to ask the Minister for Roads and Highways the update on re-awarding the bitumen surfacing of Mpasaaso Number 2 to the Asuorkor feeder road, as there was a recommendation to terminate the contract in 2023.

Mr Agbodza: Mr Speaker, thank you for the opportunity.

Mpasaaso No.2 — Asuorkor

Background

Mpasaaso No.2 – Asuorkor Feeder Road is a section of road captured in the Department of Feeder Roads DFR database as Wioso - Wansamire Feeder Road (40.86km). The road section from Wioso – Mpasaaso No.1, which is 19.5km long, is paved and in fair surface condition, whereas the section from Mpasaaso No.1-Mpasaaso No.2-Asuorkor–Wasamire is partially engineered and in poor surface condition. It is located in the Ahafo Ano South West District of the Ashanti Region.

The road was divided into two phases and awarded under two separate contracts as follows:

- a) Bitumen Surfacing of Mpasaso No.2 – Asuorkor Feeder Road Ph. I (Km 0.0 – 7.4)
- b) Bitumen Surfacing of Mpasaso No.2 – Asuorkor Feeder Road Ph. II (Km 7.4 – 23.5)

The above roads (a and b) were awarded under the contracts titled “Bitumen Surfacing of Mpasaso No.2 – Asuorkor Feeder Road Ph. I (Km 0.0 – 7.4)” and Bitumen Surfacing of Mpasaso No.2 – Asuorkor Feeder Road Ph. II (Km 7.4 – 23.5).

The contracts commenced on 6th October, 2020 for completion by 5th October, 2021. The contractors failed to commence works on site resulting in no physical works done. The contracts were terminated on 6th May, 2024.

Current Programme

There is no programme on the road.

Future Programme

Engineering design studies have been carried out on the entire 40.86km of the road for consideration under the 2026 Budget upon the availability of funds.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Any supplementary question?

Mr Onyina-Acheampong: No supplementary question, Mr Speaker, except to thank the Minister.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you very much.

Hon Members, the Question numbered 208 which stands in the name of Mr Robert Wisdom Cudjoe, Member of Parliament for Prestea Huni-Valley.

Hon Member, you have the floor.

Measures to Improve the Prestea and Huni-Valley Township Roads.

Mr Robert Wisdom Cudjoe (NDC — Prestea Huni-Valley): Mr Speaker, I beg to ask the Minister for Roads and Highways the measures being

implemented to improve the Prestea and Huni-Valley township roads.

Mr Agbodza: Mr Speaker,

Background

Prestea and Huni-Valley are towns within the Prestea Huni-Valley Municipality in the Western Region with Bogoso as its capital town. 10.15km of roads within the municipality were upgraded to bituminous surface roads under the Sinohydro Master Programme. Substantial completion of these roads was in June 2022 with Defect Notification Period ending in June 2023.

Current Programme

The Department of Urban Roads shall continue to undertake routine and periodic maintenance activities of both the paved and unpaved roads within the municipality.

Future Programme

Engineering studies of the road network will be undertaken to identify roads that need upgrading, rehabilitation or reconstruction by the end of the fourth quarter of 2025. Project implementation shall, however, be dependent on the availability of funds.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Member, any supplementary question?

Mr Cudjoe: Mr Speaker, this is some information. This bituminous surfacing programme was undertaken only in parts of Prestea, but for the Huni-Valley

township, the contractor just dug some gutters and left the project, so that is the information.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, question.

Hon Members, the Question numbered 206 which stands in the name of Dr Albert Tetteh Nyakotey, Member of Parliament for Yilo Krobo.

Dr Albert Tetteh Nyakotey: Mr Speaker, I wish to withdraw the Question.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you very much. Question accordingly withdrawn.

Hon Members, the Question numbered 207 which stands in the name of Dr Albert Tetteh Nyakotey, Member of Parliament for Yilo Krobo.

Hon Member, you have the floor.

Dr Albert Tetteh Nyakotey: Mr Speaker, I wish to withdraw this Question as well.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: The Question numbered 207 accordingly withdrawn.

Then we move to the Question numbered 209 which stands in the name of Mr Dapaah Elvis Osei Mensah, Member of Parliament for Ahafo Ano South West Constituency.

Hon Member, you have the floor.

Mr Onyina-Acheampong: Mr Speaker, I come under the same Order and I have the authorisation of the Member to ask the Question on his behalf.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Please, go ahead.

Progress on the Upgrade to Bitumen Surfacing of Wiawso to Wansamere Feeder Road

Mr Akwasi Gyamfi Onyina-Acheampong *on behalf of Mr Dapaah Elvis Osei Mensah (NPP — Ahafo Ano South West):* Mr Speaker, I beg to ask the Minister for Roads and Highways the progress on the upgrade to bitumen surfacing of the Wiawso to Wansamere feeder road stretch (Km: 12.00- 40.37) which was awarded to contractors in 2018.

Mr Agbodza: Mr Speaker, the Mpasaaso number 2 — Is this Question numbered 208 or 209?

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, it is the Question numbered 209.

Mr Agbodza: Mr Speaker,

Wiawso (Wioso) — Wansamere Road

Background

The Mpasaaso No. 2 — Asuorkor road (Km 7.4 — 23.5) forms part of the Wioso — Wansamere Road (40.86km). The road section from Wioso — Mpasaaso No.1, which is 19.5km long, is paved and in fair surface condition, whereas the

section from Mpasaaso No.1- Mpasaaso No.2-Asuorkor–Wansamere is partially engineered and in poor surface condition. It is located in the Ahafo Ano South West District of the Ashanti Region.

Current Programme

A section of the road from Wioso to Wansamere (Km 12.00-40.37) was captured under the contract titled “Bitumen Surfacing of Mpasaaso No.2 — Asuorkor Feeder Road Ph. II (km 7.4 — 23.5)”. The road was awarded under the contract titled “Bitumen Surfacing of Mpasaaso No.2 — Asuorkor Feeder Road Ph. II (Km 7.4 — 23.5)”.

The contract commenced on 6th October, 2020 for completion by 5th October, 2021. The contractor failed to commence works on site resulting in no physical works done. The contract was terminated on 6th May, 2024.

Future Programme

Engineering design studies have been carried out on the entire 40.86km of the road for consideration under the 2026 Budget upon the availability of funds.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Any supplementary questions?

Mr Onyina-Acheampong: Yes, Mr Speaker. Can the Hon Minister give assurance to prioritise this road in the 2026 Budget as indicated?

Mr Agbodza: Mr Speaker, we prioritise every public road in the

country and we shall consider this in the next budget based on the availability of funds.

5.18 p.m.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, may I on behalf of the House thank the Hon Minister for Roads and Highways for attending upon the House to respond to the Questions.

Hon Minister, you are hereby discharged.

Hon Members, let us move to Urgent Questions scheduled for the Minister responsible for Transport who is here to respond to those Questions.

Hon Minister, kindly take your seat.

The Question numbered 6(f) standing in the name of Mr Emmanuel Kwaku Boam, Hon Member for Pru East. You have the floor.

Mr Emmanuel Kwaku Boam (NDC — Pru East): Thank you, Mr Speaker. I want to seek your indulgence to withdraw this Question. Thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Question numbered 6(f) accordingly withdrawn. Question numbered 6(g) standing in the name of Mr John Darko, Member of Parliament for Suame.

Hon Member, you have the floor.

URGENT QUESTIONS

MINISTRY OF TRANSPORT

Update on Renovation of Kotoka International Airport, Terminal 2

Mr John Darko (NPP— Suame): Mr Speaker, I beg to ask the Minister for Transport to update the House on the renovation of Kotoka International Airport (KIA), Terminal 2, the purpose of the renovation, the cost and the source of funding.

Minister for Transport (Mr Joseph Nikpe Bukari) (MP): Thank you, Mr Speaker. Mr Speaker, in recent times, Terminal 3 at the Kotoka International Airport has witnessed increasing passenger volumes and congestion during peak hours. To address this, the Ghana Airport Company Limited has developed a plan to convert Terminal 2 into a dual-purpose facility that can support Terminal 3 during peak times.

Mr Speaker, the purpose of the repurposing is one, to maximise the use of Terminal 2, thereby reducing reliance on Terminal 3 and enhancing airport capacity. Two, to position Terminal 2 to handle increasing domestic and international passenger volumes. Three, a dual-purpose Terminal 2 will also provide an alternative passenger facilitation, ensuring seamless operations during peak travel periods or emergencies that may affect Terminal 3.

Mr Speaker, the project is fully funded by Ghana Airport Company Limited through its Internally Generated Funds (IGF) under the Capital Expenditure budget to a total cost of US\$9,493,150.00.

Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Any supplementary question?

Mr Darko: Mr Speaker, on this, there is no supplementary question.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you. We now move to question the numbered 6(h), also standing in the name of Mr John Darko, Member of Parliament for Suame.

Hon Member, you have the floor.

Plans Taken to Fix the Breakdown of Parking Cashiers at KIA

Mr John Darko (NPP— Suame): Mr Speaker, I beg to ask the Minister for Transport whether the Ministry is aware of the breakdown of the parking cashiers or the pay station at the Kotoka International Airport (KIA) and what the Ministry is doing to fix it.

Thank you very much.

Minister for Transport (Mr Joseph Nikpe Bukari) (MP): Thank you, Mr Speaker. Mr Speaker, the Ministry is informed of the issue and steps are being taken by Ghana Airport Company Limited to resolve it. This will include the replacement of old equipment and the

introduction of digital payment options such as POS and mobile payment platforms.

Mr Speaker, currently, a new equipment has been installed at some major car parks at the Kotoka International Airport and is at testing phase. Mr Speaker, this will run until 31st July, 2025. Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, any supplementary question?

Mr Darko: Yes, Mr Speaker. Hon Minister, in the meantime, what is the Ministry doing to ease the burden of travelers who have had to spend several minutes queuing to pay before they can leave the parking lot?

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Minister?

Mr Bukari: Mr Speaker, the Ministry, through the Ghana Airport Company Limited, is increasing the number of cashiers at the parks. We have also increased the number of the POS from three to six, and again, we are increasing the number of payment platforms from three to six too. We believe that this will help reduce the congestion and the traffic during peak hours.

Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, we then move to the item numbered 7 to take question number 89, standing in the name of Mr Kojo Oppong Nkrumah, Hon Member for Ofoase Ayirebi.

ORAL ANSWERS TO QUESTIONS

MINISTRY OF TRANSPORT

Installation of Solar Systems in Public Building for Charging Electronic Vehicles

Mr Kojo Oppong Nkrumah (NPP—Ofoase Ayirebi): Mr Speaker, I beg to ask the Minister for Transport the timelines for promoting the installation of solar systems in public building to be used for charging vehicles in accordance with Section 5.1.4(2) of the Electronic Vehicle Policy of Ghana. Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Minister for Transport (Mr Joseph Nikpe Bukari) (MP): Mr Speaker, the National Electric Vehicle Policy outlines the institutional arrangements for implementation, assigning lead responsibility for promoting the installation of solar systems in public buildings to the Ministry of Energy and Green Transition, as well as the Ministry of Works, Housing and Water Resources.

Mr Speaker, the Policy adopts a phased implementation approach, and according to the implementation roadmap, we have from 2024 to 2026 to promote the installation of solar systems in public buildings for charging electric vehicles. Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Any supplementary?

Mr Nkrumah: Yes, Mr Speaker.

Mr Speaker, in his answer, he says they have between 2024 and 2026. I want to find out from him whether in practice it has actually started as at now, and if while at that they are offering any incentives to the operators of public buildings. Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr Bukari: Mr Speaker, as I stated in my response, the lead role is within the Ministry of Energy and Green Transition, but there is a collaboration between the Ministry of Transport and the Ministry of Energy and Green Transition and some of the installations are being put in place by now and some will even be commissioned soon. The other incentive is to let the people be aware of the advantages of using Electronic Vehicles (EV) because they are cheaper to operate and they are good for general public transportation. So that is the campaign we are doing in the regions. Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you very much, Hon Minister. We then take the Question numbered 90 also standing in the name of Mr Kojo Oppong Nkrumah.

Timelines for Reviewing Existent Relevant Laws to Accommodate the EV Ecosystem in Ghana

Mr Kojo Oppong Nkrumah (NPP—Ofoase Ayirebi): Mr Speaker, I beg to ask the Minister for Transport the timelines for reviewing existent relevant laws to accommodate the electric vehicle ecosystem in Ghana and which laws it will be affected by. Thank you.

Minister for Transport (Mr Joseph Bukari Nikpe) (MP): Thank you, Mr Speaker. Mr Speaker, as outlined in the implementation roadmap of the policy, we have from 2024 to 2026 to review the current laws to support the electronic vehicle ecosystem.

Mr Speaker, some laws have already been reviewed, including the Value Added Tax (VAT) Act, 2013 (Act 870), as amended by Act 2023 (Act 1170), which introduced an exemption from VAT on the importation of electronic vehicles for public transportation. Mr Speaker, we are also reviewing the Road Traffic Regulations, 2012, L.I 2180, to accommodate the electronic vehicle ecosystem.

Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Any supplementary?

5.28 p.m.

Mr Nkrumah: Yes, Mr Speaker.

Mr Speaker, I want to find out from the Minister what he intends to do about the lopsided implementation of the VAT amendment. As of now, the implementation is only affecting large occupancy commercial vehicles and the low occupancy commercial vehicles are excluded. What does the Minister intend to do to ensure that there is equity in the application?

Mr Bukari: Mr Speaker, when it comes to taxes and their review and implementations, the lead Ministry is the

Ministry of Finance. Like I earlier stated, we are in collaboration with them, and we have time between now and 2026, and it is my belief that we would continue to collaborate and roll out the policy roadmap.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, bear with me, I have expertise in this area. On the first question, I had tried to catch your attention.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well, ask a follow-up question.

Mr Frank Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, if I may follow up, in the broader context of decarbonisation, which is relevant in the Electric Vehicle (EV) usage, apart from the possible actions you have enumerated; the amendment to existing laws. Is the Minister considering working closely with the Ministry of Finance to ensure that import duties on such vehicles are reduced to the barest minimum so that we can reduce these incumbrances in terms of how people try to import these vehicles we consider as the order of the day, which helps in the—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: You are talking about the import duties imposed by law?

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Yes, Mr Speaker.

Mr Bukari: Mr Speaker, I indicated that some exemptions are being enjoyed from the Valued Added Tax (VAT), and I stated that the lead Ministry is the Ministry of Finance because it has to do

with a lot of expenditure that will be considered.

We have a roadmap to 2026, and I gave the assurance that we will continue to collaborate with the Ministry of Finance, for us to ensure that we roll out all the policies that are stated in the National Electronic Vehicle Policy Framework.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, let us move to the Question numbered 91, also standing in the name of Mr Oppong Nkrumah.

Timelines - Government to provide monetary and non-monetary incentives for the penetration of EVs into Ghana

Mr Kojo Oppong Nkrumah (NPP — Ofoase/Ayirebi): Mr Speaker, I beg to ask the Minister for Transport the timelines for the programme of the Government to provide monetary and non-monetary incentives to facilitate the penetration of EVs into Ghana in accordance with section 5.1.1 of the Electronic Vehicle Policy of Ghana.

Mr Bukari: Mr Speaker, to drive the uptake of electric vehicles, both monetary and non-monetary incentives are necessary. According to the implementation roadmap, the first phase, spanning from 2024 to 2026, focuses on creating these financial and non-financial incentives.

Mr Speaker, the Value Added Tax (VAT) Act 2013 (Act 870), as amended by Act 2023 (Act 1107), which

introduced an exemption from VAT on the importation of electric vehicles for public transportation, has already taken effect.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Any supplementary question?

Mr Nkrumah: Yes, Mr Speaker.

Mr Speaker, I want to find out from him when the Government will present this programme of incentives to Parliament.

Mr Bukari: Mr Speaker, do you have any interest in electronic business? **Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Please, you only address the Chair.

Mr Bukari: Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr Nkrumah — *rose* —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Former Minister, kindly resume your seat.

Mr Bukari: Mr Speaker. I stated that we are going to collaborate with the Ministry of Finance, that is the lead Ministry in this regard. So we will continue to do the collaboration, and within the framework, the time given from now to 2026, we will soon be in this House to roll out all the incentives.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Minority Chief Whip?

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, the Minister repeatedly has observed that the Minister of Finance will play an

important role, which is one aspect of the connecting factors or the variables. However, there are variables which are also relevant, such as garage operators, mechanics and academia, because the question has to do with the penetration of EV vehicles in our country. And I further want to find out from the Minister, if in his pursuit of the Ministry of Finance support, he is also considering these variables which are key in the implementation and the penetration of EVs in our country.

Mr Bukari: Thank you, Mr Speaker. With the role of the Ministry of Transport in this roadmap, we are doing sensitisation in all those areas. All the educational institutions, we have done up to 13 regions, leaving three, and the roadmap gives us up to mid-year next year to be able to complete the nationwide sensitisation, to let them understand the importance of engaging in the electronics. Because they will bring down our costs and also our environment would be safe when we all engage in the EV usage. So, awareness is being created, and we are collaborating with the Ministry to also look at the financial aspects, and then we will be able to implement as directed by the roadmap.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, I want to say that I have some skills in this area, and if the Minister would not mind, I will offer him a *pro bono* service for him to continue—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, you can engage the Minister privately.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, I am saying it for the record. The Minister is my friend.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Does the Minister need your *pro bono* services on the Floor of Parliament?

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: No, he is my friend and I am just offering myself.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, the Question numbered 114, standing in the name of Mr Seth Osei-Akoto, a Member of Parliament for Atwima Mponua and former Chief Director— *[Laughter]*

Mr Seth Osei-Akoto: Mr Speaker, I seek your indulgence to withdraw the Question.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well. Question accordingly withdrawn.

Hon Minister, on behalf of the House, we thank you sincerely for attending upon the House and responding to all Questions scheduled for you. You are accordingly discharged.

Yes? Majority Chief Whip, do you have any indication? Question time has ended.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, that is so. We are now ready to do some Business. The Report from the Committee on Food, Agriculture and Cocoa Affairs in respect of the Fisheries Bill that was referred to them is ready.

Two Reports, actually. So, Mr Speaker with your leave. Let us reference the Motion.

5.38 p.m.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Minority Chief Whip, what do you say? We are now at Public Business. However, we vary the order of Business.

We take the Motion numbered 16.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, I am in full support. He knows.

Mr Speaker, when he gets my cooperation, you see him full of smiles. But I also want to remind him that there are outstanding businesses. The Members at his back; the morale is low. We would support him to do his business.

Mr Speaker, the morale is low. He should take a cue. *[Laughter]* But I support it.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Majority Chief Whip, please take note of the concerns raised. He says the morale is low. You need to energise everybody.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, cue duly taken.

Thank you very much.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: At commencement of Public Business, items numbered f(i) and (ii). Chairman of the Committee.

PAPERS

By the Chairman of the Committee —

Report of the Committee on Food, Agriculture, and Cocoa Affairs on the determination of the urgency of the Fisheries and Aquaculture Bill, 2025.

Report of the Committee on Food, Agriculture and Cocoa Affairs on the Fisheries and Aquaculture Bill, 2025.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you very much, Chairman of the Committee.

Yes, Majority Chief Whip? Can we now take Motion 16?

Mr Dafeamekpor: Yes, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Chairman of the Committee?

MOTIONS

Suspension of Order 104(1)

Chairman of the Committee (Dr Godfred Seidu Jasaw): Mr Speaker, I beg to *move*:

That notwithstanding the provision of Order 104(1) of the Standing Orders which requires that a motion shall not be debated until at least two sitting days have elapsed after the notice to move the motion is given, the motion for the adoption of the Report of the Committee on Food, Agriculture and Cocoa Affairs

on the determination of the urgency of the Fisheries and Aquaculture Bill, 2025 may be *moved* today.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, Motion moved. Any seconder?

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: I thought 16 is a procedural Motion.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: That is the procedural Motion that he has moved.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Hon Jasaw moved Motion 16? Mr Speaker, I rise to second the Motion.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well. Motion moved and seconded. This is a procedural Motion.

Question put and Motion agreed to.

Resolved accordingly.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes?

Mr Dafemekpor: Mr Speaker, consequentially, may we take the Motion numbered 17?

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well. Chairman of the Committee, you may now move the Motion numbered 17.

Determination of the Urgency of the Fisheries and Aquaculture Bill, 2025

Chairman of the Committee (Dr Godfred Seidu Jasaw): Mr Speaker, I beg to *move*:

That the honourable House adopts the Report of the Committee on Food,

Agriculture and Cocoa Affairs on the determination of the urgency of the Fisheries and Aquaculture Bill, 2025.

Mr Speaker, while moving the Motion that you adopt the Report that we are presenting to this House, allow me to give a few highlights on the justification for the urgency. Mr Speaker, I request the *Hansard* to capture the full content of this Report as if it was read in its entirety.

Mr Speaker, allow me to give you a brief history, and also highlight some aspects for the *Hansard* because of the fact that, this Bill was considered in the Eighth Parliament and in the Eighth Parliament, we could not go through the full process and so, it expired with the term of the previous Parliament.

Fortunately, some Members of your Committee also find themselves in the same Committee on Food, Agriculture and Cocoa Affairs where this Bill has been referred to again. Mr Speaker, we realised that there was then an opportunity for the Ministry to imbibe its energy and vision into the new legislative framework for consideration.

Mr Speaker, we accordingly took your referral, considered it, and in our deliberations, we observed a lot of stakeholder interest in bringing new dimensions to a modern way of managing the fisheries industry. So, we took a lot of those considerations on board, and made substantial changes and revisions attending to some of the provisions that have been provided.

Mr Speaker, I refer the House to page 3 and 4 of this Report where there is a table that extensively captures most of the revisions that have been made to the provisions.

Mr Speaker, for the fact that you gave it on the Certificate of Urgency, we realised that we needed to include this together with the Attorney-General, and then re-lay the Bill. Mr Speaker, it has now been incorporated in the new Report and the Bill before the House, and it has accordingly been re-laid for the consideration of the House. I so submit, Mr Speaker, the urgency is relevant, and I invite this House to consider the Report, recommending that the Bill be taken on the certificate of urgency.

Respectfully submitted.

Introduction

On Tuesday, 3rd June, 2025, a Fisheries and Aquaculture Bill, 2025 was presented to the House by the Hon Minister for Fisheries and Aquaculture (MoFA), Madam Emelia Arthur. During the process of presentation and First Reading, the Minister requested that the Bill be considered under certificate of urgency. The Bill was accordingly referred to the Committee on Food, Agriculture, and Cocoa Affairs for consideration and report in accordance with Article 106 (4), (5) & (13) and Orders 160(2) & 239 of the Standing Orders

The Committee on Food, Agriculture, and Cocoa Affairs held a number of meetings to consider the Bill. The

Committee, in its deliberations, received inputs from the Minister for Fisheries and Aquaculture, senior officials of the Ministry, the Fisheries Commission, the National Premix Fuel Committee, and officials of the Attorney-General's Office & Ministry of Justice, the Ghana Tuna Association, the Canoe & Fishing Gear Owners Association of Ghana (CaFGOAG), Environmental Justice Foundation (EJF), amongst others.

The Committee further received comments and suggestions from international organisations that regulate the fisheries industry globally, particularly the following:

- (a) the Directorate-General for Maritime Affairs and Fisheries (DG MARE) of the European Commission;
- (b) the Food and Agriculture Organisation (FAO) of the United Nations; and
- (c) the United Nations Office on Drugs and Crime (UNODC).

In order to integrate relevant international feedback into the Fisheries and Aquaculture Bill, 2025, the Committee, in collaboration with officials of the Ministry of Fisheries and Aquaculture and its agencies, as well as representatives of the Attorney-General's Office, took note of the inputs received from the agencies of the European Commission and the United Nations in respect of the following clauses:

Determination of the Urgency of the Fisheries and Aquaculture Bill, 2025

	Clause	Headnote
i.	12	Fisheries Settlement Committee
ii.	38	Marine fisheries management plan
iii.	39	Marine fisheries reserve
iv.	40	Designation of inshore exclusion zone
v.	43	Designation of inland exclusion fishing zone
vi.	49	Prohibition of illegal, unreported and unregulated fishing
vii.	51	Importation of vessel to engage in fishing and fishing-related activities
viii.	56	Prohibition of fishing or fishing-related activities without a fishing licence
ix.	58	Qualification for licence to operate Ghanaian fishing vessel
x.	59	Application for licence to operate Ghanaian industrial fishing vessel
xi.	60	Application for licence to operate Ghanaian semi-industrial fishing vessel
xii.	61	Application for licence to operate foreign fishing vessel
xiii.	64	Refusal of application for fishing licence
xiv.	65	Suspension, modification or cancellation of fishing licence
xv.	66	Validity and renewal of fishing licence
xvi.	77	Record of licences
xvii.	120	Investigation and enforcement of directives

xviii.	123-124	Functions of the Fisheries Enforcement Unit Authorisation for electronic surveillance
xix.	127	Immunity from legal proceedings
xx.	132	Designated device
xxi.	137-138	Destruction of evidence Liability of master and an officer of a company
xxii.	143	Compounding Offences Committee
xxiii.	168	Regulations
xxiv.	169	Interpretation

The Committee also recalls that Ghana was issued a “yellow card” by the European Commission (EC) in 2021 for failing to adequately tackle Illegal, Unreported, and Unregulated (IUU) fishing. Thus, Ghana is tagged as a non-compliant country in the fight against illegal fishing activities.

Failure to act swiftly in changing the legal regime could result in the issuance of a Red card by the EU. A red card would result in a complete ban on the exportation of fish and fishery products to the European market, leading to an estimated loss of US\$425,969,296.32.

Considering the extensive consultations held with stakeholders in the fishing industry as well as the Committee’s own deliberations that has resulted in a tall order of proposed amendments, the Committee accordingly requested the Attorney-General’s officials to incorporate the proposed amendments into the Bill for presentation to Parliament. This is intended to abridge the time anticipated to be spent at Consideration Stage of the

Bill as well as to expedite its passage in order to avoid the issuance of a Red card by the EU.

New Fisheries and Aquaculture Bill, 2025

Following the incorporation, by the Attorney-General’s Office, of the numerous proposed amendments into the Bill, the Hon Minister for Fisheries and Aquaculture sought, and was granted leave to withdraw the earlier Fisheries and Aquaculture Bill, 2025 which was presented to the House on Tuesday, 3rd June, 2025. The Hon Minister subsequently presented a new Fisheries and Aquaculture Bill, 2025 to Parliament on Tuesday, 8th July, 2025. In accordance with Standing Order 160(1), the Minister requested that the Bill be considered under certificate of urgency.

The Bill was consequently referred to the Committee on Food, Agriculture, and Cocoa Affairs for consideration and report in accordance with Article 106 (4), (5) & (13) and Orders 160(2) & 239 of the Standing Orders.

Accordingly, the Committee urgently met on Tuesday, 8th July, 2025, and considered the referral.

Observations

The Committee noted that all the relevant amendments, suggestions, and comments received from key stakeholders including those from agencies of the European Union and the United Nations have been incorporated into the new Fisheries and Aquaculture Bill, 2025. The revised Bill strengthens the legal and institutional framework for the sustainable management of Ghana's fisheries and aquaculture resources, while promoting compliance with international standards.

Urgency for Passage of the Bill

Given the inadequacies of the Ghana's legislative framework on the fisheries industry, the new Fisheries and Aquaculture Bill, 2025 has been crafted, after extensive consultations, to modernise the existing legal framework to better support the sustainable fisheries resource management, enhance food security and the sector's contribution to national development. These legislative reforms are also designed to align Ghana with international fisheries management obligations, ensuring both ecological and economic sustainability in the long term.

By way of emphasis, it should be noted that Ghana has been issued a "yellow card" by the European Commission (EC) in 2021 for failing to adequately tackle Illegal, Unreported, and Unregulated (IUU) fishing. Thus,

Ghana is tagged as a noncompliant country in the fight against illegal fishing activities. Failure to act swiftly in changing the legal regime could result in the issuance of a Red card by the EU. A red card would result in a complete ban on the exportation of fish and fishery products to the European market, leading to an estimated loss of US\$425,969,296.32.

Considering the extensive consultations held with stakeholders in the fishing industry as well as the Committee's own deliberations, the Committee is confident that the Bill in its current form suffices to deal with modern trends in the fishing industry. The consultation process involved a wide range of stakeholders across artisanal, semi-industrial, and industrial fisheries, academia, civil society, legal experts, and development partners, ensuring that the proposed legislative reforms are inclusive, evidence-based, and aligned with best practices in sustainable fisheries governance.

Taking cognisance of the issues addressed herein, it is the considered opinion of the Committee on Food, Agriculture and Cocoa Affairs that the Fisheries and Aquaculture Bill, 2025 in its current form, be taken under a certificate of urgency pursuant to Article 106(13) of the Constitution and Order 160(3) & (4) of the Standing Orders of Parliament.

After a careful consideration of the Bill in accordance with Article 106 (5) & (13), and pursuant to Order 160(3), the Committee hereby informs the House

that the Fisheries and Aquaculture Bill, 2025 is of an urgent nature and should be considered pursuant to Article 106(13) and Standing Order 160(4) of Parliament.

Question proposed.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, Motion moved and Report presented.

Yes, you have the floor.

Ranking Member of the Committee (Dr Isaac Yaw Opoku): Mr Speaker, I second the Motion on the floor. Mr Speaker, as you are aware, the drafting of this Bill started way back in 2022 and as the Chairman has indicated, it has gone through a lot of transformation, review upon review and again, as you are aware, we have already been shown the yellow card.

Mr Speaker, in football circles, if one is shown a second “yellow card”, it means Red card. We should not wait until we are shown another “yellow card”.

Mr Speaker, we risk losing our export to the European market. So, I urge this House to support the Committee in adopting the Report of the Committee for it to be taken under the certificate of urgency.

Thank you very much, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, Motion moved and seconded. Hon Members, as indicated by the

Chairman of the Committee, this is a similar Motion moved, seconded and debated by the House. We are again at this stage because the proposed amendments of the Committee and others were integrated into the Bill. So, the old one that has been debated was withdrawn and reintroduced.

In view of this, how many contributors do we take at this stage? Do we take the Leadership and then I will put a Question?

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, that is the agreement.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well. Minority Chief Whip, you have the floor.

Minority Chief Whip (Mr Frank Annoh-Dompreeh): Mr Speaker, let me, first of all, commend the Leadership of the Committee, both Chair and Ranking Member and I cannot leave out the Minister who has strongly followed through on these matters. Looking at the Report, I think there is a consensus on both Sides of the Committee that it should be taken under the certificate of urgency. So, there is no debate about it.

I am happy because if one reads the Report, clearly captured is what the Committee has done in terms of the consultation. My worry has been the consultation. We all know how the issues have been sprawling in terms of the fishing industry. I know the Minister is an expert in this area. But my worry has often been what has been the extent of consultation in these matters.

Oftentimes, we are in a hurry to sign an international agreement. Do not forget, we have taken a prior decision by signing an agreement which is relevant. Now we are trying to incorporate some of the content of the agreement signed into this Bill. That, I commend the Minister highly.

The Ranking Member could not have captured the concerns rightly when he spoke to the “yellow card” status that, as a country, we have attracted and we cannot delay further to attract a Red card. That would be an avoidable pain. So, Mr Speaker, without adding more, I think I support it. So, let us proceed and take the decision and then move on to the next stage. So, we commend the Minister highly for this swift action to change the legal regime which I think is very important. Thank you.

5.48 p.m.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you very much. Yes, Majority Chief Whip?

Majority Chief Whip (Mr Rockson-Nelson Etse Kwami Dafeamekpor): Mr Speaker, I adopt the submissions from my Brother as though they were mine and to add that, reference to paragraph 4, sub-paragraph 2 of the Report, page 7 of 8, the essence of the urgency of taking this Bill with alacrity is aptly captured.

Mr Speaker, we are told, especially in the second sentence, that:

“...Ghana is tagged as a non-compliant country in the fight against illegal fishing activities. Failure to act swiftly in changing the legal regime could result in the issuance of a red card by the European Union (EU).”

Mr Speaker, the Report is further indicating that:

“A red card will result in a complete ban on the exportation of fish and fishery products to the European market, and this could lead to an estimated loss of US\$425 million.”

Mr Speaker, we are speaking pure matters of extreme commercial value to the nation. So, with these words, I urge the House to adopt this Report, so that the Bill can be taken under certificate of urgency.

I thank you for the opportunity.

Question put and Motion agreed to.

Resolved accordingly.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: May we skip the Motion numbered 18 and take the Motion numbered 19?

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, that is so.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Minister for Fisheries and Aquaculture Development, you have the floor to take the Motion numbered 19.

BILL — SECOND READING

Fisheries and Aquaculture Bill, 2025

Minister for Fisheries and Aquaculture Development (Ms Emelia Arthur): Mr Speaker, I beg to *move*:

That the Fisheries and Aquaculture Bill, 2025 be now read a Second time.

Chairman of the Committee (Mr Godfred Jasaw Seidu): Mr Speaker, I support the Motion and in so doing, I submit your Committee's Report for adoption.

Mr Speaker, following your leave to redraw and relay the Bill, your Committee had a meeting yesterday, the 8th July, 2025 and considered the referral.

Mr Speaker, I urge the *Hansard* to capture the full content of the Report as if it was fully read to this House.

Introduction

On Tuesday, 3rd June, 2025, a *Fisheries and Aquaculture Bill, 2025* was presented to the House by the Hon Minister for Fisheries and Aquaculture (MoFA), Madam Emelia Arthur. During the process of presentation and First Reading, the Minister requested that the Bill be considered under certificate of urgency. The Bill was accordingly referred to the Committee on Food, Agriculture, and Cocoa Affairs for consideration and report in accordance with Article 106 (4), (5) & (13) and

Orders 160(2) & 239 of the Standing Orders

The Committee on Food, Agriculture, and Cocoa Affairs held a number of meetings to consider the Bill. The Committee, in its deliberations, received inputs from the Minister for Fisheries and Aquaculture, senior officials of the Ministry, the Fisheries Commission, the National Premix Fuel Committee, and officials of the Attorney-General's Office & Ministry of Justice, the Ghana Tuna Association, the Canoe & Fishing Gear Owners Association of Ghana (CaFGOAG), Environmental Justice Foundation (EJF), among others.

From the onset, the Committee took cognizance of the work of the Committee on Food, Agriculture and Cocoa Affairs of the Eighth Parliament. That Committee had actually carried out extensive consultations with the Ministry of Fisheries and Aquaculture and various stakeholders in the fisheries industry on the Bill. The text of the Bill as presented to the House on Tuesday, 3rd June 2025 therefore reflected the outcome of the broad consultations and extensive discussions with critical stakeholders.

It is gratifying to note that a number of Hon. Members of the previous Committee on Food, Agriculture & Cocoa Affairs are also Members of the Committee of the Ninth Parliament. The institutional memory of these Hon. Members in relation to the Bill and their contributions made, really enriched the deliberations of the Committee as well as the amendments proposed to the Bill.

The Committee further received comments and suggestions on from international organisations that regulate the fisheries industry globally, particularly the following:

- a) the Directorate-General for Maritime Affairs and Fisheries (DG MARE) of the European Commission;
- b) the Food and Agriculture Organisation (FAO) of the United Nations; and

- c) the United Nations Office on Drugs and Crime (UNODC).

In order to integrate relevant international feedback into the Fisheries and Aquaculture Bill, 2025, the Committee, in collaboration with officials of the Ministry of Fisheries and Aquaculture and its agencies, as well as representatives of the Attorney-General's Office, took note of the inputs received from the agencies of the European Commission and the United Nations in respect of the following clauses:

	Clause	Headnote
i.	12	Fisheries Settlement Committee
ii.	38	Marine fisheries management plan
iii.	39	Marine fisheries reserve
iv.	40	Designation of inshore exclusion zone
v.	43	Designation of inland exclusion fishing zone
vi.	49	Prohibition of illegal, unreported and unregulated fishing
vii.	51	Importation of vessel to engage in fishing and fishing-related activities
viii.	56	Prohibition of fishing or fishing-related activities without a fishing licence
ix.	58	Qualification for licence to operate Ghanaian fishing vessel
x.	59	Application for licence to operate Ghanaian industrial fishing vessel

xi.	60	Application for licence to operate Ghanaian semi-industrial fishing vessel
xii.	61	Application for licence to operate foreign fishing vessel
xiii.	64	Refusal of application for fishing licence
xiv.	65	Suspension, modification or cancellation of fishing licence
xv.	66	Validity and renewal of fishing licence
xvi.	77	Record of licences

	Clause	Headnote
xvii.	120	Investigation and enforcement of directives
xviii.	123-124	Functions of the Fisheries Enforcement Unit Authorisation for electronic surveillance
xix.	127	Immunity from legal proceedings
xx.	132	Designated device
xxi.	137-138	Destruction of evidence Liability of master and an officer of a company
xxii.	143	Compounding Offences Committee
xxiii.	168	Regulations
xxiv.	169	Interpretation

Mr Speaker, having had extensive consultation with the relevant stakeholders, and taking cognizance of the tall order of the amendments proposed, the Committee was of the

considered opinion that the Attorney-General's Office incorporates the amendments into the Bill and the Bill re-laid in the House for expedited passage. The Committee humbly took this view

considering the long period anticipated it may take the House to deliberate on the Bill at the Consideration Stage.

Mr Speaker, the Committee also recalls that Ghana was issued a “yellow card” by the European Commission (EC) in 2021 for failing to adequately tackle Illegal, Unreported, and Unregulated (IUU) fishing. Thus, Ghana is tagged as a noncompliant country in the fight against illegal fishing activities. Failure to act swiftly in changing the legal regime could result in the issuance of a *Red card* by the EU. A red card would result in a complete ban on the exportation of fish and fishery products to the European market, leading to an estimated loss of US\$425,969,296.32.

Considering the extensive consultations held with stakeholders in the fishing industry as well as the Committee’s own deliberations that has resulted in a tall order of proposed amendments, the Committee accordingly requested the Attorney-General’s officials to incorporate the proposed amendments into the Bill for presentation to Parliament. This was intended to abridge the time anticipated to be spent at Consideration Stage of the Bill as well as to expedite its passage in order to avoid the issuance of a Red card by the EU.

New Fisheries and Aquaculture Bill, 2025

Following the incorporation of the numerous proposed amendments into the Bill by the Attorney-General’s Office, the Hon Minister for Fisheries and

Aquaculture sought, and was granted leave to withdraw the earlier Fisheries and Aquaculture Bill, 2025 which was presented to the House on Tuesday, 3rd June 2025.

The Hon Minister subsequently presented a new Fisheries and Aquaculture Bill, 2025 to Parliament on Tuesday, 8th July 2025. In accordance with Standing Order 160(1), the Minister requested that the Bill be considered under certificate of urgency.

The Bill was consequently referred to the Committee on Food, Agriculture, and Cocoa Affairs for consideration and report in accordance with Article 106 (4), (5) & (13) and Orders 160(2) & 239 of the Standing Orders.

Accordingly, the Committee urgently met on Tuesday, 8th July, 2025, and considered the referral.

Observations

The Committee noted that all the relevant amendments, suggestions, and comments received from key stakeholders including those from agencies of the European Union and the United Nations have been incorporated into the new Fisheries and Aquaculture Bill, 2025.

The revised Bill strengthens the legal and institutional framework for the sustainable management of Ghana’s fisheries and aquaculture resources, while promoting compliance with international standards.

Revision of the Memorandum and sections of the Bill

The Memorandum to the Bill has been revised to reflect Ghana's commitment to the Blue Economy agenda. This underscores the importance of harnessing marine and aquatic resources sustainably to support economic growth, social inclusion, food security, and environmental protection. Sections of the Bill that provides for the Blue Economy include the Long Title, Clause 4(1)(y), and the Interpretation.

Governing Board of the Fisheries Commission

The composition of the Governing Board of the Fisheries Commission under Clause 5 of the Bill has been revised to enhance multi-stakeholder representation and technical oversight. Two key additions have been made:

- a) A representative from the Veterinary Services Division of the Ministry of Food and Agriculture, to ensure integration of fish health and food safety perspectives; and
- b) A representative from the Ghana Tuna Association, nominated by the Association, to reflect the importance of the industrial tuna sector and promote stakeholder participation.

Expanded mandate of the Fisheries Commission

The functions of the Fisheries Commission have been expanded to include the promotion of a sustainable blue economy to reflect the revised Memorandum [see Clause 4(1)(y)].

Conclusion and Recommendations

The fisheries and aquaculture sectors contribute significantly to national development particularly in the areas of job and wealth creation, poverty reduction, Gross Domestic Product contribution and foreign exchange and will remain so provided the resources are managed sustainably.

The sustainable management, utilization and exploitation of the fisheries and aquaculture resources require the existence of robust legal framework that govern fishing activities, regulates resource extraction, and ensures compliance with international and national environmental standards.

However, the Fisheries Act, 2002 (Act 625), since its enactment in 2002 and the Fisheries (Amendment) Act, 2014 (Act 880), which empower the Minister to develop regulations aimed at combating Illegal, Unreported and Unregulated fishing, have not seen major changes to reflect emerging trends in sustainable fisheries management.

Given the inadequacies of the Ghana's legislative framework on the fisheries industry, the new Fisheries and Aquaculture Bill, 2025 has been crafted, after extensive consultation, to modernise the existing legal framework to better support the sustainable fisheries resource management, enhance food security and the sector's contribution to national development. These legislative reforms are also designed to align Ghana with international fisheries management obligations, ensuring both ecological and economic sustainability in the long term.

By way of emphasis, it should be noted that Ghana has been issued a "yellow card" by the European Commission (EC) in 2021 for failing to adequately tackle Illegal, Unreported, and Unregulated (IUU) fishing. Thus, Ghana is tagged as a noncompliant country in the fight against illegal fishing activities. Failure to act swiftly in changing the legal regime could result in the issuance of a Red card by the EU. A red card would result in a complete ban on the exportation of fish and fishery products to the European market, leading to an estimated loss of US\$425,969,296.32.

Considering the extensive consultations held with stakeholders in the fishing industry as well as the Committee's own deliberations, the Committee is confident that the Bill in its current form suffices to deal with modern trends in the fishing industry. The consultation process involved a wide range of stakeholders across artisanal, semi industrial, and industrial

fisheries, academia, civil society, legal experts, and development partners, ensuring that the proposed legislative reforms are inclusive, evidence-based, and aligned with best practices in sustainable fisheries governance.

Taking cognizance of the issues addressed herein, and after careful consideration of the Bill, the Committee accordingly recommends that the House adopts its Report on the Fisheries and Aquaculture Bill, 2025, and pass the Bill in accordance with Article 106(13) and Standing Order 160(4) of Parliament.

Respectfully Submitted

Question proposed.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, the Report has been duly presented and pursuant to Standing Order 127, a full debate shall arise on the principle, the rationale, the mischief that the Bill is seeking to cure on the basis of the Explanatory Memorandum and the Report of the Committee.

Again, this Report has been taken by this House, debated, and adopted. We move to a Consideration Stage. We are back at this stage, owing to the fact that some amendments have been integrated leading to the reintroduction of the Bill.

How many contributors do we then take?

Yes, Majority Chief Whip?

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, we have agreed that we will take two from each Side—*[Interruption]*—No, hold on.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Ranking Member of the Committee, I get a sense; one from each Side.

Ranking Member of the Committee (Dr Isaac Yaw Opoku): Mr Speaker, last week, I visited my doctor and I was asked to cut down on the intake of red meat. But the same doctor recommended that I increase my consumption of fish. So, that is how important the fishery industry is.

Mr Speaker, it is so important that we cannot allow the fish stocks to be depleted. The current law, Fisheries Act, 2002 (Act 625), has not seen any major review; a lot of the international requirements have not been cured. If we come to the local level as well, there are a lot of deficiencies, so, this new law is to cure the deficiencies.

Mr Speaker, the old law concentrated mainly on marine fisheries. Very little attention was given to aquaculture and those of us from the inland are so much interested in aquaculture. The youth of this country are also very much interested in going into aquaculture. This new Bill has taken care of all the laws governing the aquaculture.

Mr Speaker, the old law also did not address the climate change and we know that, these days, any law which does not address climate change will be so

deficient, but this new Bill takes into consideration climate change.

Mr Speaker, any law which is forced on stakeholders, especially the small-scale fisheries, is not likely to work. So, this new Bill takes into consideration, the core management of the fishery industries.

Mr Speaker, so this new Bill has a lot of strict rules to govern illegal, unreported, and unregulated fisheries. So, I recommend for the adoption of the Report by this House.

Mr Speaker, I so submit.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Thank you very much.

Yes, Mr Gakpey?

Vice Chairman of the Committee (Mr Kwame Dzudzorli Gakpey): Mr Speaker, thank you for giving me the opportunity.

Mr Speaker, the old law is disjointed and then currently the new Bill is trying to actually merge all the laws to make it one law where it can be run by the industry. Laws are not static; they are dynamic. New things are emerging, especially when it comes to marine protected areas. We are talking about blue economy, increasing nature of the aquaculture in the country and the new issues emerging in terms of technology and climate change.

These are the new emerging issues that need to be addressed by the new Bill. Ghana is on yellow card at the EU and if care is not taken, Ghana is going to lose almost about US\$425 million. If that happens, it will have direct impact on our economy.

Mr Speaker, so in view of this, I call on the House, as a matter of urgency, to adopt this Report.

Question put and Motion agreed to

Fisheries and Aquaculture Bill, 2025 accordingly read a Second time.

5.58p.m.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon members, item number 21, the Fisheries and Aquaculture Bill, 2025 at the Consideration Stage.

Mr Dafeamekpor —*rose*—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Majority Chief Whip, you are on your feet.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, I agree that some incorporations of the proposed amendments have been done, but if you may oblige us, the Winnowing Committee will meet this evening and deal with it, so that when we come tomorrow morning, we can expressly deal with it. It is quite voluminous. My fear is that if we want to go through it on the Floor, it may attract other

amendments which we could take at winnowing. So, anybody who is interested in proposing amendments will join us at winnowing—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Majority Chief Whip, if you are proposing that Members would want to take a look at the refined Bill, I will agree with you. Having referred the Bill to the Winnowing Committee and it was out of that Committee that some amendments were integrated into the Bill, I intend not to subject it or refer it to the Winnowing Committee anymore. But I can abide by your suggestion that we do the consideration tomorrow.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, I am entirely in your hands.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, I think our Colleague, who is a very experienced person—I see my senior, Hon Anyimadu-Antwi, is also here. Mr Speaker, out of practice, I think we have often resorted to this laying, so I am in support.

Mr Speaker, today, I have been supporting him. I have supported him well enough, but I had also cautioned him to take a cue from the mood of the House. In supporting him, I will go beyond him and plead with the Whips—Acheampong, look into my eyes—*[Laughter]*—Mr Speaker, we should have a Committee of the Whole. Mr Speaker, I have already supported him with his application; there is no doubt about that—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Except that, I would want to say that at the Consideration Stage, we should do a few clauses, in the sense that clauses like “Application of the Act”, “The Object of the Commission”, “Functions of the Commission”, “Governing Body of the Commission”, “Duties and Liabilities of Members of the Board”, “Tenure of Office of the Members of the Board”, and “Meeting of the Board”. Hon Members, these are provisions that are standard in most of the Bills that we pass.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, we defer to you, so let us make progress.

Mr Anyimadu-Antwi —*rose*—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So, we will take a few clauses and leave it at the Consideration Stage and continue tomorrow.

Yes, Hon Anyimadu-Antwi, my very good Friend?

Mr Anyimadu-Antwi: Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr Speaker, I rise to support the Majority Chief Whip that we go through the clauses, but he made a statement that because it is voluminous, he may want us to go through it fast. I would want to remind him that we necessarily have to go through them one after the other. So, we need some time to go through it thoroughly. I am, for the first time, having a copy of this Bill. So, tomorrow, we can go through them; we need time. I support him.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: For the first time? Before it was referred to the Winnowing Committee? Were you not part of the Winnowing Committee?

Mr Anyimadu-Antwi: No, Mr Speaker, nobody had invited me on this Bill. I am supposed to be, but nobody has invited me. So, Majority Chief Whip, please, check your notes.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well.

Yes, Hon Acheampong?

Mr Acheampong: Mr Speaker, the Minority Chief Whip mentioned my name when he made his submission. Mr Speaker, you advised us yesterday to engage each other and we did. He even smiled to me this afternoon that, at least, one of the issues has been properly resolved—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Acheampong, your engagement is not for our record.

Mr Acheampong: So, for him to raise it again—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: I am saying, your engagement is not for our record. So, Hon Minority Chief Whip, take note, after engagement, you do not raise the issues again.

Very well. We will still leave the Bill at the Consideration Stage. If any Member has a proposed amendment, we will take it tomorrow.

Yes, Hon Shaibu?

Mr Shaibu Mahama: Mr Speaker, that is exactly what I wanted to say.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well.

Hon Members, the Fisheries and Aquaculture Bill, 2025, at the Consideration Stage.

BILLS — CONSIDERATION STAGE

Fisheries and Aquaculture Bill, 2025

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Majority Chief Whip, any indication?

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, may we take up to clause 10.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, I am guided. Once it is at Consideration Stage, we have to do some clauses before we leave it.

Chairman of the Committee, any proposed amendments?

Dr Jasaw: No, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, the Committee does not have any proposed amendment to clause 1.

However, it is for the consideration of the House. Any proposed amendment?

Clauses 1 and 2 ordered to stand part of the Bill.

Clause 3 — Object of the Commission

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Chairman of the Committee?

Dr Jasaw: Mr Speaker, there is no proposed amendment.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, there is no proposed amendment from the Committee. It is, however, for the consideration of the House.

Any proposed amendment?

6.08 p.m.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, clause 3, I believe that this House is not simply enacting a law with an object for long term conservation but an effective long-term conservation.

So, I propose that after “long-term” we should *insert* “effective conservation, development, management and utilisation of fisheries and aquaculture resources through the (a),(b),(c),(d),(e), (f), (h). Mr Speaker, I so propose.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, the proposal is to introduce “effective”.

Yes, Minority Chief Whip?

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: I know the Majority Chief Whip is very diligent on such matters, but conservation is conservation. We cannot use an adjectival phrase or modify conservation; that is the standard term

that is used. So may I impress upon my Colleague, I know he wants to beautify that clause, but it is not something we can modify. So may he withdraw his amendment and then we can proceed.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, I am clearly not supposed to take part in the debate, but can we all look at the memorandum accompanying the Bill. Page 1, paragraph 1. It reads:

“The purpose of the Bill is to review and consolidate the laws relating to the sustainable exploitation of fisheries resources, establish the Fisheries Commission to ensure the long-term conservation...”

So, what is contained in the Bill as it is, is in conformity with the memorandum accompanying the Bill.

Hon Majority Chief Whip?

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, I have been part of the enactment process for some time. Reading the memorandum, we seek to consolidate the existing legal framework and to make it better. We are not simply consolidating; we seek to make it more effective. That is the essence of this new legislation.

So, for me, inserting it in the phrase to give effect to it is not fatal to the terms of the memorandum. And Mr Speaker, I will litigate this, but I will gauge the mood of the House. My Brother is litigating it but I do not think it is fatal at all.

My position is simply that there have been conservation practices. As we speak, the existing legal framework ensures conservation, but we are decrying its inadequacies. That is why we want to consolidate the existing laws and introduce new practices that will go to make the law more effective. It is about being more effective, not proceeding with the *status quo ante*. So, my belief is that if we qualify it with “effective”, we will still be in conformity with the memorandum. But Mr Speaker, I will leave this entirely in your hands. You can put the question.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, because the “conservation” has been qualified by “long term”.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Yes.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: And you want it to be “effective long term”?

Mr Dafeamekpor: Yes, long term in terms of longevity. No, Mr Speaker, long term is in respect of longevity; it is not a short-term conservation practice. It can be “short term effectively”. It is about the policy direction. But the point I am making is that the essence of this law, if we engage all the stakeholders, their sentiments is about making things more effective going forward. So, I will leave it here, Mr Speaker. Let us make some progress.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well. Yes, Hon Shaibu Mahama?

Mr Shaibu Mahama: Mr Speaker, even though his amendment is not fatal, I will entreat him to drop that so that we are a bit consistent with the language of the memorandum.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So, Hon Majority Chief Whip –

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, let us put the question. I may have people supporting me, so let us make progress.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So, should I put a question on the proposed amendment? Then give us— Yes, Chairman of the Committee?

Mr Jasaw: Mr Speaker, I thank you for the opportunity. I have heard the Majority Chief Whip and going by his suggestion and argument, the converse of “effective” will be ineffective.

Mr Speaker, conservation is a term of art. Conservation is conservation. We are not aware of ineffective conservation; that will put some bias judgement. And I think that it is safer that the law does not introduce this bias. Who decides what is effective and what is not effective? So, I submit respectfully that we should allow it to stay as it is. “Long-term conservation” will be sufficient.

Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Dafeamekpor, the Chairman of the Committee is saying that the use of the word “effective” will bring some element of subjectivity into the law. Who determines whether the “long-term

conservation” is effective or it is not effective?

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, last point, then I will leave this. Mr Speaker, we have the Green Ghana programme. It is a form of a conservation programme. The problem has been how effective it has been. So, essentially, we can have a conservation programme, but it may not be effective. That is all I am saying. Mr Speaker, I will leave it here. Let us make progress.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, but do the needful once you are agreeable to the sense of the House.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, put the question and let us make progress.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Dafeamekpor, sometimes—

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, withdrawn.

Clause 3 ordered to stand part of the Bill.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, do we proceed? Clause 4.

Clause 4 – Functions of the Commission

Mr Jasaw: Mr Speaker, we do not have a proposed amendment.

Thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, the Committee does not have

a proposed amendment. It is, however, for the consideration of the House. Yes, Hon Kwame Anyimadu-Antwi, you have the floor.

Mr Anyimadu-Antwi: Yes, Mr Speaker, I do not have any proposed amendment, but I would want to find out from the Chairman — I have perused through and realised that the Commission is to collaborate with some institutions. Would he consider the Gold Board that had been set up quite recently, especially the taskforce? Because they have to go around the water body and most of the time when it has to do with gold, they have some linkage with water bodies. So, I just want him to give it a consideration and then maybe tomorrow we can consider it if it will be necessary.

Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Chairman of the Committee. The proposal is, will you consider the Gold Board?

Dr Jasaw: Mr Speaker, we can allow it to stay as it is and allow the managers of the Ministry to see who the workable collaborators will be. That way, we allow flexibility. If we zero in on Gold Board, then we are legislating that the Gold Board must always be there to be collaborated with.

I so submit, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well. Yes, Minority Chief Whip?

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, may I revert the mind of the Chairman to—I think we are on clause 4, the fourth line, and it reads, Mr Speaker:

“In the established priorities for the utilisation of fishery resources, which will provide the greatest benefits to the country and ensure the proper conservation.

It is clause 4.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Clause 4 (1) (a).

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Yes, in line with the memorandum, I think what we are using is “long term”.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So, you are looking at the memorandum but not the clause?

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: I am actually looking at clause 4.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes. Clause 4 has (1) (a), (b), (c), and (d).

Which one are you talking about?

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Just a minute, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So, is that clause 4 (1) (c)?

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, let me get back. *[Pause]*

Mr Speaker, if you may indulge me. Yes. That is 4(1)(c) “Functions of the Commission” Yes, and he is saying, “ensure the proper conservation”. I have issues with “proper”. Mr Speaker, I think in line with the memorandum, we should use “long-term” so that it is consistent.

The rendition will read; “ensure long-term conservation of the fishery resources through the prevention of overfishing and other prohibited fishing practices.” We are just doing away with “proper conservation” and replacing “proper” with “long-term”.

6.18 p.m.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Chairman of the Committee?

Dr Jasaw: Mr Speaker, I agree. It is a proper rendition.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well.

Question put and amendment agreed to.

Clause 4(1)(c) as amended ordered to stand part of the Bill.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, any further amendment? Hon Members, I will put the Question on the entire Clause 4.

Yes, Hon Member?

Alhaji Collins Dauda: Thank you, Mr Speaker. I rise to seek clarification on clause 4(1)(k) which reads; shall in consultation with the Ghana Standards

Authority and any other relevant agencies, standardise fish quality, weight and the basis for fish pricing.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, it is clear. Chairman of the Committee, the Hon Member wants clarification on that.

Dr Jasaw: Thank you, Mr Speaker. Mr Speaker, the thinking is that we are moving to commercialising the product, fish, so this is being prepared for local markets as well as the export market. Therefore, standardisation becomes a key requirement and in line with the Ghana Standards Authority, which has standards already documented, we wish that this aspect of the law allows for that synergy, so that our fish products can be standardised for our local and international markets. Thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, let me add that the quality testing is done by the Standards Board.

Alhaji Dauda: Mr Speaker, while I appreciate standardising fish quality and weight, I have a challenge when it comes to standardising basis for fish pricing, if you can elucidate on that.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Mr Shaibu?

Mr Shaibu Mahama: Mr Speaker, yes, perhaps if we tweak the sentence, it will make a bit— “In consultation with the Ghana Standards Authority and any other relevant agencies provide standards for fish quality, weight and the basis for fish pricing”.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Well, Hon Members, I think what is causing the problem is “and the basis of fish pricing”. They can provide the quality standard which will form the basis. But if you are saying “and the basis of fish pricing, then it means that you are expecting Ghana Standards Board to provide the—Yes, so what can happen is that the standard fish quality, weight, as the basis of fish pricing.

So, if you use those standards and the weight as basis for fish quality, that is fine. But if you said, “and the basis”, then it means that after the Standards Board provides you with the quality standard and then the weight, they will go ahead and tell you the basis for the fish quality.

So, Hon Members, I think the “and” should go and replace it with “as”. Now, on the same clause, based on the singular principle, should it be “relevant agencies” or “relevant agency”? Because in drafting, singular means plural. But plural does not mean singular.

So, Hon Members, a Member should own the proposal and give the rendition for us to put the Question.

Yes, Mr Mahama?

Mr Shaibu Mahama: Mr Speaker, just before I even get to the thrust, the plural and singular bits you mentioned, I think we can still stick to the plural in this context, “relevant agencies”.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Well, Mr Anyimadu-Antwi, let us hear you on this issue.

Mr Shaibu Mahama: Mr Speaker, I am still on the floor or you want me—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: But you have made a suggestion and I am throwing it for the consideration of Members.

Mr Shaibu Mahama: Mr Speaker, let me get to the thrust first. In the new rendition, so “in consultation with the Ghana Standards Authority and any other relevant agency provide standards for fish quality, weight and pricing”.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, I am not supposed to take part in the debate, but just to provide a guide. I think the new rendition should be “in consultation with Ghana Standards Authority and any other relevant agency, standardise fish quality and weight as the basis for fish pricing.”

6.28 p.m.

Mr Shaibu Mahama: Very well, Mr Speaker. So, I am adopting the new rendition that you have supported the House to build.

Question put and amendment agreed to.

Clause 4(1)(k) as amended ordered to stand part of the Bill.

Hon Members, any further amendments? Yes, Hon Anyimadu-Antwi?

Mr Anyimadu-Antwi: Mr Speaker, I would want the Chairman to educate me on clause 4(1) (p):

“Make recommendations to the Minister for the formulation of policies...”,

And especially, the latter part that says:

“...and grant of licences related to the object of this Act”.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Are you talking about clause 4 (1) (p)?

Mr Anyimadu-Antwi: Yes, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well.

Mr Anyimadu-Antwi: So, the first part says, “make recommendations to the Minister for the formulation of policies”. Now it is also saying that, “and grant of licences related to the object of this Act”. Does it mean that the recommendations are to the effect of the grant of licences? That is where I do not understand. So, if he can educate me on the same. What I am saying, Mr Chairman, is that I do not have any problem where clause 4 (1) (p) says, “make recommendations to the Minister for the formulation of policies”. But I want education on the latter part which says, “and grant of licences”.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Chairman of the Committee?

Dr Jasaw: Yes, Mr Speaker, that is the intendment. That is it, Hon Member.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Habib?

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, I think Chairman should get the right rendition to read as he tries to explain clause 4 (1) (p), because Hon Anyimadu-Antwi’s concern is, “and grant of licences related to the object of this Act”. So, if it is “make recommendations to the Minister for the formulation of the policies” and we bring “and grant of licences related to the object of this Act”, it does not come out well in drafting. Maybe, Mr Speaker can guide us on this.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Well, let me hear the Majority Chief Whip before if there is the need, I will provide it.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, I see the mischief the Ranking Member has detected. The recommendation is not about how to formulate the policies. So, “formulation” must go. So, it should be:

“Make policy recommendations to the Minister for the grant of licences related to the object of this Act.”

Yes, it is not a formulation that they are recommending — *[Interruption]*. No, it is not the formulation; it is policy recommendations. One does not tell the Minister how to formulate the policies. One recommends policies.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members —

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, if I may formulate my point. The essence of this provision is to say that as part of the functions, they will make recommendations to the Minister. What kind of recommendations are they making? They are making policy

recommendations for the implementation by the Minister. How would the Minister implement this policy? It is regarding grant of licences. But with the way it is couched, it is as if we are recommending formulation of policies to the Minister. No, but the formulation of policy is not what this body would be recommending; they are making policy recommendations.

In fact, Mr Speaker, this is a standard provision. I do not know why we are struggling. We made this provision —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, let us look at clause 17 of the Bill. Though I have a problem with the rendition 17, but let us look at it. When we get there, then we will know what to do.

Normally, it is not Ministerial directives; it is policy directives. It says that:

“The Minister may give directives to the Commission on matters of policy and the Commission shall comply.”

So, all that the Bill is saying is that there will be recommendations based on which the Minister will formulate policies. There will be recommendations based on which the Minister may take decisions to grant licences. So, the provision is talking about two things and all is in the nature of recommendation. It does not mean that they are doing the policy themselves. So, if you look at it together with clause 17, it means that based on those recommendations, it is a

recommendation to the Minister as a guide for the Minister formulating policies. So, they are not to do the policy, but to make recommendations and these recommendations will lead to policy and will also guide the Minister in granting licences. So, I think the rendition is all right as it is.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: I agree more with Mr Speaker. It is what it is and it is straightforward. So, I think we should abide by this. I have been trying to signal to the Chairman that we should abide by what is existing there. The rendition is perfect and we should just leave it. Let us not disturb it unnecessarily.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well. Any further proposed amendments to clause 4?

Yes, Hon Kabiru?

Dr Abdul Kabiru Tiah Mahama: Thank you, Mr Speaker. I will take a look at (n). The current rendition reads:

“...in collaboration with other stakeholders, hear and determine complaints from persons aggrieved in respect of matters arising from or related to the fishing activities and the fishing industry, except criminal matters.”

Mr Speaker, my proposal is for us to expunge “criminal matters” because the law is settled and the jurisdiction of this particular Act will automatically be ousted when it comes to matters of a criminal nature. So, I was just thinking that to make it simpler, it could read:

“...in collaboration with other stakeholders, hear and determine complaints from persons aggrieved in respect of matters arising from or related to fishing activities and the fishing industries.”

And we could leave it at that. The reason is that if we want to qualify every single thing, then we will be making reference to the limitation.

Thank you very much, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Dafeamekpor?

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, I agree with him because there is a different legal regime governing criminal matters. So, we do not need to except it.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Well, it is for the consideration of the House. Yes, Hon Anyimadu-Antwi?

Mr Anyimadu-Antwi: Mr Speaker, it is on a different issue.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: On a different issue?

Mr Anyimadu-Antwi: Yes.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, do you not think this is here to remind everybody that once the matter is criminal in nature, you cannot receive a complaint in any manner whatsoever. That is the general principle of the law.

Very well.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, that scarecrow is not needed. If it is going to serve as a scarecrow, it is not needed in this context. We do not need it because the rendition is very clear when we take the criminal matters out.

Mr first Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Shaibu?

Mr Shaibu Mahama: Mr Speaker, this is not fatal; it is for emphasis so that the commission is guided. I think that we should leave it as it is.

6.38. p.m.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Because, remember, Members who are being guided here may not be lawyers to know that, by the imperative of some law, one cannot delve into criminal matters, but when the provision is here saying that you can do it, but when it is a matter relating to criminality, it is a no. That is what the rendition is saying, so, it is there as a guide.

Yes.

Mr Mahama: The mischief this proposed amendment seeks to cure is that we are basically saying the Act can deal with any matter, except criminality; that is the meaning. But assuming that a husband and a wife fight over fish, is it a case that this Act can address it?

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, if a husband and wife is fighting over fish and the fighting is not a criminal offence, it means that they can resolve the

problem for them. But so long as it constitutes assaults, then it is a criminal offence for which they cannot resolve. That is the understanding I am gathering here.

Mr Shaibu Mahama: Mr Speaker, I understand that some fight could even be private, which goes into the area of Tort law, where a person can have a private cause in the law court without necessarily coming through the Act and if we limit and argue that it is only criminal matters that this Act cannot—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: The provision here does not oust the jurisdiction of the court, but it reads:

“In collaboration with other stakeholders, hear and determine complaints from persons aggrieved in respect of matters arising or related to fishing activity and fishing industry, except criminal matters.”

So, long as it is relating to fishing activity in the fishing industry, they can hear the complaint, but if it is a criminal matter, they cannot hear the complaint.

Hon Members, clarity is one of the governing principles in drafting.

But let me hear Mr Anyimadu-Antwi; then I will come to Hon—

Mr Anyimadu-Antwi: Mr Speaker, I would want to pray that, even in criminal matters, if they want to settle it out of court or out of whatever jurisdiction, I think they can deal with it. I would want

to support what he said that, except criminal matters, we can do away with those ways. This is something like arbitration clause or settlement clause that is being proposed.

I think that, except criminal matters—Even when the matters have been reported to the police and it is before court and the Commission goes in, they can settle and announce. So, if we do away with the criminal matters—If they do not want the Commission to delve into anything close to crime, the authorities will say no and that will be no.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Except that if we leave it the way it is, we may be offending Article 88(3), which makes criminal matters exclusive preserve for the Attorney-General. It is an exclusive preserve. So, what the rendition is seeking to do is to remind them that they can hear complaints, but once it is a crime, that crime is against the Republic. So, they cannot hear the complaint—Well, it is for the House to decide.

Prof Nyarko: Mr Speaker, somebody just whispered to me that I am not a lawyer, so I do not have to—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: We encourage non-lawyers to take part in the legislative process.

Prof Nyarko: Mr Speaker, yes, as long as Hon Members are willing to understand, we can make some reasonable input.

Mr Speaker, I think I share in your perspective because if we read the sub-paragraph well—

“In collaboration with other stakeholders, hear and determine complaints from persons aggrieved in respect of matters arising from or related to fishing activities and the fishing industry except criminal matters.”

There is an institution that deals with criminal issues. Criminal matters falls within the jurisdiction of the courts. If we do not make it explicit, this institution or others might veer into territories where they do not have the competence and it might even lead to damages and some negative consequences on the institution.

So, as Hon Shaibu Mahama said, even if it is a fatal injury, it is just to make it explicit that the Commission can do all, but when it comes to criminal matters, it should leave it to those who have the capacity and the competence to deal with that. That is my layman understanding of this sub-paragraph.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, this provision would rather introduce exercise of discretion. So, now, the Commission will begin to determine which matters they think are of criminal nature and which ones are not—*[Interruption]*—Hold on. So, my view is that the proposal by Dr Kabiru is accurate. We do not need the provision because the object of the Bill is very clear.

So, in functioning a role for the Commission, we must not entertain this danger. As soon as this danger is there, when the matter comes up, they will now be exercising a discretion to the extent that they will not even be determining criminal matters where they are not supposed to. They will say the law says except criminal matters, so we thought that this one is not a criminal matter. We are rather adverting their mind to the fact that— Because in the fishing industry, two vessels, and my Brother Jerry is here, can fight over fuel at sea and they can fight over fish catch. Sometimes, the area of fishing can overlap and when two boats cast a net and haul the net, the two nets can overlap in the course of hauling the catch. It can result in a quarrel over the high seas.

So, let us be very clear that these are their functions. Anytime there are matters of that nature, it is the police— And now we have the Marine Division of the Ghana Police Service. They are mandated to deal with these matters. When it is about inland, we have divisional police, district police, and police stations dotted around the lake that can handle these matters.

But my fear is that, once we put this provision there, then the commissioners will now think that they have the power to exercise their discretion. So, they will then be making the judgement over the matters. So, it is not needed and it is needless. I hinted it to the drafters; I do not know how come it still survived up to this stage.

Mr Speaker, it is not needed at all, with all due respect.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Well, Mr Jerry Ahmed?

Mr Shaib: Mr Speaker, I concur with my Brother, Mr Dafeamekpor, especially to the extent that now criminal matters even go before Alternative Dispute Resolution (ADR). So, what is the effect, really? Matters which are criminal matters are sent to ADR. A case in point yesterday, one happened and the judge asked that they go and have it sorted at ADR.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So, in that case, is the judge not invoking Section 73 of the Court Act?

Mr Shaib: Well, but that is the case. But that is subject to the approval.

6.48 p.m.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, that is why I said that we do not deal with the criminal matter. If the criminal matter goes to court and Section 73 is invoked, then that is a different ball game altogether.

But for me, I do not think we have a discretion to determine that this is a criminal matter or not and the law is clear, that nothing is a crime if at the time it is done, there is no law that makes it a crime. Therefore, once the law makes it a crime, you do not have a discretion to determine whether it is a crime or not; the element of discretion is not there.

Yes, Hon Anyimadu-Antwi?

Mr Anyimadu-Antwi: Mr Speaker, we are grateful for your guidance, but what we want to say is that crime, even though it is designated that the Attorney-General and Minister for Justice will be in charge, even with that, we go into settlement. So, now that we are putting in a clause to promote efficiency within the fishing industry, bringing that caveat is not necessary because even when the parties are gone to sea, like the Majority Chief Whip said, if their nets had overlapped and it had resulted into something else, we can say that is a crime.

Even though the Commission can settle it, they will now say that well, due to what we have said, because one person insulted the other, this is a crime and they are not going into that. I think we can do away with that. Where there is a serious criminal offence that has been committed, nobody would need to force anybody out. So, if we *delete* those three words, “except criminal matters”, I am sure we will be fine.

Prof Nyarko: Mr Speaker, I am surprised we are belabouring this position. Having this provision there brings clarity, so that the institution would not veer itself into territories that do not belong to their functions. Are we saying that the institution has the power to determine that A or B are criminal acts? No, they would have to yield to the jurisdiction of the institution that can do that. There is no discretion in this matter. There is no discretionary issue in this matter; this is clear plain white.

I am not a lawyer. This is my layman's view and I think that this layman's view makes sense, so let us keep it and make progress.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, I think we have dragged this matter for some time. If the Chairman or the Minister could throw more light. If we take—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Chairman of the Committee?

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, I am not done yet.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, if we take the “except criminal matters” out or leave it there, what would be the harm to that very clause? Will this now mean that they can handle criminal matters that happen around the sea, rather than the appropriate authorities that are supposed to handle criminal matters that happen at sea? If they throw more light, then we can cure this and move on.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: But Hon Member, it is clear that if you take it out, you are giving them unlimited jurisdiction. You are not restricting their jurisdiction by taking out elements of crime, so if they do it, it is within the ambit of the law. Technically speaking, the law does not allow them to deal with criminal matters. Even if it is not there, you cannot do it; that is my understanding.

But by being there, it is for the purposes of emphasis that, do not do this because it is something that already, by operation of law, you cannot do. But to make it clear, by reinstating the position of the law, you cannot deal with criminal matters. That is the reason for the proviso. But I need to take inspiration from the House.

All right, let us hear the proposer of the amendment.

Dr Mahama: Mr Speaker, this is going to be, of course, my last submission on this point before your determination and then the Chairman can respond.

Mr Speaker, if we provide this limitation to the law, it means that any other thing, whether there are relevant laws governing those particular other matters, this Bill can take care of them. That is the meaning of this particular exception we are providing. However, if we leave this without this particular exception, it means that wherever there are certain matters regulated by some laws, those applicable laws will come into effect.

For instance, the UN Convention on the Law of the Sea, there are matters which are going to be deliberated within international tribunals. Mr Speaker, when those matters, guided by international laws, are going to be determined, do we say that because those matters are not criminal in nature and it is an issue of arbitration and a matter that we have to deal with, those people do not

have records to use those international bodies?

And this is the mischief that this proposed amendment seeks to cure. That we know, as a fact, that criminal matters are regulated by the criminal jurisdiction, and Act 29, rightly so, helps us in dealing with those things. But when we come to other matters, there could be certain matters that this particular Act may not have the jurisdiction, but it is not expressly stated.

That is why I am arguing and proposing that when we leave it at “matters”, we know that we are talking of context and those that are related to that particular Bill and that there will not be any ambiguity whatsoever. But once we state “except criminal matters”, it means that they can handle international matters.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Well, let us get this clear. Can they hear a complaint in relation to illegal fishing?

Dr Jasaw: Mr Speaker, thank you very much—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: No, I am asking Dr Kabiru Mahama. Can they hear a complaint in relation to illegal fishing?

Dr Mahama: Mr Speaker, if there are provisions in our fishing laws, illegal fishing is a criminal matter.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Can they hear a complaint in relation to unregulated fishing?

Dr Mahama: Unregulated means fishing is criminal. If one does anything that is not regulated by the law, it is criminal, so they cannot—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: What of unreported fishing?

Dr Mahama: If unreported fishing is also part of the Bill, it is criminal.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So, what I am understanding this to do is that if the issue is in relation to Illegal, Unreported and Unregulated Fishing (IUU), it is a no go area.

Well, let us hear the Chairman of the Committee, then we can put the Question.

Dr Jasaw: Mr Speaker, as you know, the context of this Bill is to actually strengthen the legal regimes for governing the fisheries industry. Based on the stakeholder consultations and other interactions with the Attorney-General’s Department, this particular point came up in our deliberations. I recall the Majority Chief Whip brought it up earlier and it was advised that because we are aiming at strengthening and emphasising criminality, we need to be clear that if the Commission assumes powers of criminal investigation, then it is counterproductive.

So, the Commission can engage in arbitrations and resolve issues that are not of criminal nature. If it relates to crimes such as IUU and related activities, it is important that that provision emphasises that if it is of a criminal

nature, then it is for some other provisions or some other bodies to deal with, not the Commission. Based on experience, if we allow it open like this, the Commission might assume some powers that they do not have and that Acts 29 and 30 do not allow them to engage in.

Mr Speaker, this has been deliberated extensively and we think that it is better to allow the rendition to stay as it is to serve the purpose and object of this Bill.

I so submit, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, what is the sense of the House?

Yes, Majority Chief Whip?

6.58 p.m.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, clearly, let me say this, it has become a litigious point but I second Dr Mahama, and now I will re-emphasise my point. Mr Speaker, if we leave this *proviso*, it means we are now asking the Commission to sieve the complaints. Discretion—They have the power to deal with it; another one appears criminal so we do not have the power to deal with it. We do not need that discretion so that it will be subject to abuse. Then tomorrow an appeal or a proper lawsuit may emerge in respect of exercise of a discretion which they did not have.

So, I believe that under clause 149 and 150, “provide the procedure for an appeal when some parties are aggrieved

against the decision of the Commission”. Secondly, Mr Speaker, when we leave the provision this way, we may have to go and define complaints. The complaints that will come before the Commission will mean A, B, C, because we have to provide clarity. That will enable the Commission to say that a particular complaint that has come before them is a matter bordering on criminality or criminal offence and therefore it must fall in the domain of the relevant agency if the provision is actually referenced to a collaboration of relevant agencies.

So, Mr Speaker, from where I stand, if we take it out, it brings clarity to it. Nobody’s mind is exercised or averted to anything—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Majority Chief Whip, you see, I am getting you but where I am not getting clearly is that the Commission will be sieving what constitutes a crime or what does not constitute a crime. Our chiefs can settle every dispute except that of criminal nature. So, when matters go before even the chiefs, they are able to determine that it is stealing, which is a criminal offence, so they will not do it because stealing has been defined by law.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, the Chieftaincy Act, 2008 does not provide for those. But Mr Speaker, you are my senior, both in this House and at the Bar, and you have done some chieftaincy cases and some traditional arbitration. Mr Speaker, the chiefs fall into a lot of error by exercise of jurisdictions, by

handling the criminal matters like defilement and even rape. They do because they fall into the error and exercise their mandates; there are no exceptions.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: No, so once they have been falling into that arena, if we now have a law which is expressly telling them that they should not engage in this, do you not think it will help the situation where we will be falling into the arena?

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, if we read this law, the object, the applicability of the act and all that—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Well, Hon Members—Dr Kabiru Mahama, propose your amendment, let me put a Question on it and the House will take a decision. I think we should make progress.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: We have spoken at length. I have been quiet listening. Initially, I was not for the amendment that Dr Kabiru Mahama moved. I was against it, but now I think I am getting persuaded that the thing should go, particularly the last points made by the Majority Chief Whip. But if it is the case that there are still strong views, Mr Speaker, I may just humbly call upon you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Well, I believe we have debated this matter enough in pepper and hart. The debate will be a guide to interpretation.

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Yes, we should make progress. Otherwise, we

can call on the drafters to advise us. Or probably, Mr Speaker, we should seek the view of the Minister on this matter. She is a sector person; let us listen to her too.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So, let me listen to the Minister, then I can put a Question.

Minister for Fisheries and Aquaculture (Mrs Emelia Arthur) (MP): Thank you, Mr Speaker. The statement “except criminal matters” was introduced—And by the way, as you know, the Office of the Attorney-General and Ministry of Justice have worked endlessly on what we have today. It was introduced to cure the current situation where the settlement committee have major challenges and sometimes veer into spaces that they should not; like criminalities and all sorts. We are on national television, so I do not want to—

So, we thought that if this is here, it specifies for the settlement committee, the window of operation and makes things clearer and tighter for them to operate as an arbitration team. If people do not understand, then they go to court. So, Mr Speaker, I would want it to stay as it is, if the House so agrees.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Dr Mahama, please read the proposed amendment so that—

Dr Mahama: Thank you very much, Mr Speaker. But my respected Colleague raised an important issue about the Chieftaincy Act, 2008 and I wanted to

draw your attention to it so that it may equally affect the decision of the House.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Please propose an amendment.

Dr Mahama: Mr Speaker, the proposed amendment, I propose that it should read:

“...in collaboration with other stakeholders, hear and determine complaints from persons aggrieved in respect of matters arising from or related to fishing activities and the fishing industry.”

Thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, the proposal that I am going to put a Question on is to *delete*, “except criminal matters”.

Question put and amendment negated

Mr Anyimadu-Antwi: Mr Speaker, since your answer suggests that you are not sure, I know you are going to put the Question again. Mr Speaker said, “I think”. He did not rule, he said, “I think”. So, Mr Speaker is not sure; let us settle on this.

Chairman of the Committee, I would still want to persuade the House, inclusive of the Speaker, that even—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: The Speaker needs not be persuaded. I do not take part in the voting. So, when I said, “I think the Noes have it”, it meant I was

not clear. So, I intend to put the Question again. Before putting the Question, Dr Kabiru Mahama is proposing that we should *delete* “except criminal matters”. The proponents of the Bill are saying it should stay in the rendition. So, I am putting the Question on the proposal by Dr Kabiru Mahama that “except criminal matters” should be *deleted*. Order! I will put the Question again.

7.08 p.m.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, just as you are about to put the Question, our Hon Colleagues should know that this is a stage of considering the Bill. It is not about National Democratic Congress (NDC) or New Patriotic Party (NPP). Even their Majority Chief Whip is in support of what Dr Mahama is saying. So, Mr Speaker, you can put your Question.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Habib, with the discussion that has happened across the board, this is not politicised.

Hon Members, my explanation is to guide in terms of the voting. So, I am stating that I am putting the Question on the proposed amendment by Dr Kabiru Mahama that “except criminal matters” be deleted from clause 4(1)(n).

Question put and amendment negated.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Any further amendments?

Yes, Hon Minority Chief Whip?

Mr Annoh-Dompreh: Mr Speaker, we have no further amendment. You put the Question and the decision was arrived at. I will further pray this House that the Chairman consult further on this matter. Even though a decision has been arrived at, let us consult further on this matter and find a way to fine-tune this thing which is very important.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well. Chairman, take note.

Is there any further amendment to clause 4?

Yes, Prof Nyarko?

Prof Kingsley Nyarko: Mr Speaker, I would like to attempt to propose an amendment on clause 4(1)(w), “establish and promote effective collaboration and co-operation among key national and international organisations in fisheries and aquaculture management.”

I am proposing that we *delete* “effective” because effective is difficult to define and determine. If one does not have indicators to do that then it veers into an arena of subjectivity. So, if we could *delete* that one so the subparagraph remains “establish and promote collaboration and co-operation among key national international organisations in fisheries and aquaculture management.” Mr Speaker, I so submit. Thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well. It is a very good observation but the Hon Chief Whip will recall that we have debated that at length in this House and

instead of deleting it we rather added efficient, “effective and efficient”. So that has been the rendition that appears in most of the laws that we have passed by this House following that particular debate. So, you are provoking the same debate again. But what will be against you is that in drafting, we dwell more on consistency in our laws. So once this has been used severally in our laws, I think here it does not give element of subjectivity because the whole thing is in the management of fisheries and aquaculture.

Prof Nyarko: Mr Speaker, you know when it comes to lawmaking in this House you are one of the best.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: No, except that where I am sitting, I cannot contribute to make the law.

Prof Nyarko: Mr Speaker, the point I am making is that I have made this observation but I trust your judgement. So, if my proposed amendment has been debated before and the House has come to a conclusion, even though it makes sense intuitively, but because of consistency, it remains. Mr Speaker, I will always yield to your superior argument. Thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well. So, I would advise that you rather add “efficient” so that it will be in line with the previous laws that we have made.

Prof Nyarko: Mr Speaker, I am guided by your wise counsel. So, I propose that after “effective”, *add* “efficient”. Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, the proposal is that in clause 4(1)(w), after “effective”, *insert* “and efficient collaboration”.

What do you say, Chairman of the Committee?

Dr Jasaw: Mr Speaker, I agree with the proposal and I further request that once this has been settled already, you order for consequential effects in all other provisions that may have this. I so submit Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: That is where it is applicable. Very well.

Yes, Dr Mahama?

Dr Mahama: Mr Speaker, indifference to your statement that that is how these laws are usually made, I would want to also draw your attention to the fact that to use efficient as an adjective for collaboration seems to be more or less a misnomer. Because efficient are used for systems and persons. And if you want to qualify collaboration, which is something soft, with the word efficient, I feel sincerely that though the law may be talking about persons and systems, but in this case, they are talking about collaboration and network.

So, if you are going to say an efficient collaboration, you are trying to qualify collaboration. And I think elaborate collaboration would have been more appropriate. I respectfully submit that; it is not in all cases that effective and efficient as adjective should be used to

qualify what we want to talk about so I think that it should stand as it is now.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well, I have no fixation.

Any further amendment to Clause 4(1)?

Yes, Mr Anyimadu-Antwi?

Mr Anyimadu-Antwi: Mr Speaker, this is minor but I am picking your words that there must be consistency and to draw the draftspersons attention to the words that have been used in plural form. So, we need to be consistent if we are taking the singular. This is because in (u), (v) and (w), and it goes through a lot of clauses. For instance, in

- (u) “promote co-operation among aquaculture practitioners”
- (v) “collaborate with relevant agencies”
- (w) “establish and promote effective collaboration and corporation among key national and international organisations”.

So, I would want to draw the draftspersons attention on whether we are going by the plural one or to go consistent by going singular which would also mean plural. I cannot offer a solution to that but I want to—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Mr Anyimadu-Antwi, you are right. Is either

we adopt the singular approach and be consistent with it or we adopt the plural approach and be consistent with it.

I would accordingly direct the draftspersons to choose appropriately.

Hon Members, is that okay with the House?

Any further amendment to clause 4?

Yes, Hon Member?

7.18 p.m.

Prof Hamza Adam: Mr Speaker, I thank you for the opportunity to come in here. I want to draw your attention to an issue of consistency. In (n), “in collaboration with other stakeholders” and then when you come to (s), you also have “collaborate with relevant stakeholders”.

I am of the view that we should try to be consistent and if possible—Mr Speaker, I went through the interpretation and I realised that “stakeholders” have not been defined, which I think is important we have a look at. Thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So, your view is that we should define “stakeholders”.

Prof Adam: My view is that, either we are using “stakeholders” or “relevant stakeholders”. We need to be consistent with that.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well.

Yes, Hon Habib?

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, for consistency, yes, but I do not know how the Hon Member wants “stakeholders” to be defined in this context. It would be difficult to define it in this context. But it is an ordinary word. If we check the context in (n) and the context in (s), we see that it is different.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: It is quite different. So, my suggestion is that if you feel that “stakeholders” is a term of act, then hold it. When we get to interpretation, you propose that “stakeholders” be interpreted and at that stage, the House will consider whether “stakeholders” is a term of act, so that definition would be provided or not. So, you can hold your amendment until we get to the interpretation.

Hon Members, we have debated clause 4 exhaustively.

Prof Adam: Mr Speaker, what about the issue I raised earlier with respect to the consistency matter?

Mr first Deputy Speaker: Look at the context. It makes a difference. There is a distinction. There must be a determination whether whatever the commission is considering, you are a relevant stakeholder. Then you will be invited accordingly to take part.

Prof Adam: Mr Speaker, and then other stakeholders—I think I am guided. Probably we need to define the two so that we can—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So, you hold it till we get to the interpretation, because we cannot be doing the definition here. Since the word stakeholder has been used generally in the Bill, it can only be under the interpretation. But assuming it is only used in clause four, then we can provide a definition for it in clause 4.

Prof Adam: Mr Speaker, I am guided.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Kingsley Nyarko?

Prof Kingsley Nyarko: My last proposed amendment to (h). Ensure—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: No, (h) says, “collaborate with district assemblies for the sustainable management.”

Prof Nyarko: But with what I am holding, the functions is clause 4. When we come to the next page, it is still about clause 4. Then at page 29, clause 4 is still there. Maybe it is the numbering that has changed.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So, you said (h).

Prof Nyarko: All right, so it is clause 4(3)(h).

Mr First Deputy Speaker: All right, clause 4(3)(h)?

Prof Nyarko: Yes, please.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, then you are now talking.

Prof Nyarko: Yes. So, “ensure the implementation of any relevant obligation of the Republic in terms of any...” —

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Well, because clause 4(1) has been amended, if we do not have any further amendment on clause 4(1), let me put a question on clause 4(1), then we can make progress.

Question put and amendment agreed to.

Clause 4 as amended ordered to stand part of the Bill.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Kingsley Nyarko?

Prof Nyarko: Mr Speaker, with respect, clause 4(3)(h) says:

“Ensure the implementation of any relevant obligation of the Republic in terms of any international agreement or applicable rule of international law.”

My issue has to do with “of any relevant obligation”. I am thinking we *delete* “of any relevant” so that it remains “ensure the implementation of obligations of the Republic” instead of saying “of any relevant obligation”. I find it to be a mouthful. So, it should read:

“Ensure the implementation of obligations of the Republic in terms of any international agreement or applicable rule of international law.”

I so submit, Mr Speaker

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Chairman of the Committee, what do you say to it?

Dr Jasaw: Mr Speaker, I respectfully disagree because the nation and its laws and the obligations we have assigned to are various, so we want this law to speak to the relevant obligations. So, I think that it is better this rendition stays so that it is not just any obligation but the relevant obligations.

That is with respect to the fisheries industry. Thank you.

Prof Nyarko: With respect, obligations that are relevant and that are not relevant—*[Interruption]*. But looking at how it is couched, it is saying that, “ensure the implementation of any relevant obligation” and my question is, which obligation is relevant and which is not? And who determines the relevance of the obligation? So, it will make much sense if we do away with any relevance and talk about obligations. This is because we know our obligations; they are defined. We know them. Thank you, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Kingsley Nyarko, Ghana has entered so many agreements, but out of the so many agreements that we have entered, it is only the one that is relevant that we can talk about here. But there are some obligations on the country regarding the subject matter that may not be relevant. Other than that, when you delete “relevant”, then you must introduce a word relating to fisheries. So here, they

are talking of the obligations in relation to fisheries. So long as it is not relevant to fisheries, this law is not saying we are under that obligation.

Prof Nyarko: Mr Speaker, I am guided, but why do we have obligations that are not relevant? That is what I do not understand. How and why should we have obligations that are not relevant? Obligations are obligations.

7.28 p.m.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So, Hon Kingsley Nyarko, if you delete it, the rendition will be:

“Ensure the implementation of obligations of the Republic in terms of any international agreement.”

So, you realise that there are some obligations of this particular Republic that has got to do with Parliament. Do you understand? So long as the Fisheries Commission is concerned, those obligations, though it is an obligation of the Republic, is not relevant to fisheries. Do you get it?

Prof Nyarko: Mr Speaker, I get it partially, but this Bill—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: You see, we have signed so many treaties. For instance, Ghana has an obligation under the International Human Rights Charter. But you would agree with me that the obligation of the Republic under the International Human Rights Treaty has nothing to do with fisheries.

Do we understand? So, if we leave it at “obligations of the Republic”, it is as if we are talking about all international obligations of the Republic. But if we introduce “relevant obligations”, it means that those treaties that Ghana has signed, the one relevant to fisheries, that is what we are talking about.

Prof Nyarko: Mr Speaker, I get you; *Speaker ntua*. You are right—*[Laughter]*—I agree.

Clause 4 as amended ordered to stand part of the Bill.

Clause 5— Governing body of the Commission.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Chairman of the Committee?

Dr Jasaw: Mr Speaker, we do not have any proposed amendments.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, any proposed amendments? The Committee does not have proposed amendments, but it is for the consideration of the House.

Yes, Majority Chief Whip?

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, in consonance with clause 1(1)(b) of the Bill, I propose that the National Premix Fuel Committee be factored into the institutional representations in the composition of the governing body of the Commission.

Mr Speaker, this is because the functions of the National Premix Fuel

Committee is so central to fishing activities and the implementation of the law clearly has a major relationship with what the National Premix Fuel Committee does, so on that basis—I proposed it to the drafters. I do not know—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, is the National Premix Fuel Committee an autonomous body?

Mr Dafeamekpor: Yes, it is also an agency under the Ministry of Fisheries and Aquaculture Development, just like the Fisheries Commission—*[Interruption]*—It is not a bite; we need to be represented on the Commission.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So, looking at the institutional representations, do we have any agency of the Fisheries Commission represented here?

Mr Dafeamekpor: Of the Ministry?

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, because what we have here is the Ghana Maritime Authority (GMA), the Ghana Police Service (GPS), the Environmental Protection Agency (EPA), the Water Resources Commission (WRC), and the Ghana Ports and Harbours Authority (GPHA).

Mr Dafeamekpor: We do not.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: And because we do not, if we advocate that the National Premix Fuel Committee be added, then, equally, other agencies

under the Ministries will have to be added here.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, there are just about two agencies under the Fisheries Commission.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Then you are proposing that the agencies under the Fisheries Commission should also be added. Is that the proposal?

Mr Dafeamekpor: The law is seeking to establish the Fisheries Commission. The Fisheries Commission already exists, but this law is to consolidate it and make it better. So, in constituting its governing body, relevant agencies are mandated to be represented on the body and I am saying that the National Premix Fuel Committee is also very relevant in respect of the work that the Fisheries Commission does, especially because of the terms in Clause 1(1)(b).

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Well, the proposal is for the consideration of the House.

Let me hear from the Hon Deputy Minority Whip first.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, I do not think the proposal from the Majority Chief Whip is something we should include. In the sense that, if we look at the work and the activities of the Fisheries Commission, I do not see where premix is coming. I remember in the Eighth Parliament we had an engagement with them. If we look at the other agencies like the Ghana Maritime Authority (GMA), the Ghana Police

Service, the Navy, and others, they are very vital agencies or authorities that take part, especially, in what happens on the sea.

I do not see where National Premix Fuel Committee get fit in. So, I do not think that it should be included in that. I do not see the relevance and the role that the National Premix Fuel Committee will play with regards to this governing body of the Fisheries Commission.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Chairman of the Committee?

Dr Jasaw: Mr Speaker, the Ministry has the National Premix Fuel Secretariat and also the Fisheries Commission. The National Premix Fuel Secretariat and its Board is chaired by our able Majority Chief Whip. We do not have representatives of the Fisheries Commission on the Board of the National Premix Secretariat. So, the Fisheries Commission Board is separate from the agencies under the Ministry.

So, the Fisheries Commission has its constitutionally mandated membership that will stay. The National Premix Fuel Secretariat and its Board also has its composition and relevant agencies that constitute it.

I submit that we should allow the current rendition to stay, so that the Commission stays as it is constituted; then the National Premix Fuel Committee also stays as it is constituted.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So, we do not have any member of the Commission

serving on the National Premix Fuel Committee?

Dr Jasaw: No, Mr Speaker.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So, we should not have a member of the National Premix Committee also serving on—

Dr Jasaw: Well, the Chairman is here. Let us hear him.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, this is a house of record. The Fisheries Commission is ably represented on the National Premix Fuel Committee because of its relevance to the work that the National Premix Fuel Committee and the Secretariat does.

They have a representative? Now, in pursuance of L. I. 2233, 2016, the composition of the National Premix Fuel Committee has a representative from the Fisheries Commission as by law established now, as we speak. Now, the point I am making is that if we read clause 1(1)(b):

“Application of the Act

Unless otherwise specified, this Act applies to fishing and fishing-related activities and any other activity or matter within the scope of this Act.”

Now, Mr Speaker, the Memorandum accompanying this Bill says that this is a law that is to encapsulate all the legal regimes and consolidate all the legal regimes existing into one consolidated Act.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well.

Hon Chief Whip, let me resolve the problem this way. This will be a policy matter because issues relating to governing body as to the composition of the board is purely a policy issue. I will, therefore, step it down and urge upon the Minister to do a further consultation in relation to the composition of the governing body.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Very well.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, on clause 5?

Prof Nyarko: Mr Speaker, with respect—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Is it on clause 5?

Prof Nyarko: Mr Speaker, we are supposed to adjourn after five hours. We have gone beyond the required time for us to sit. Mr Speaker, my senior, Hon Anyimadu-Antwi, is very tired and I can see from—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: What is the time now?

Prof Nyarko: Mr Speaker the time is 7:37 p.m.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well.

So, you are asking me to extend the period to 8:00 p.m.

So, accordingly, I use my discretion to extend the period to 8:00 p.m.

Yes, Mr Anyimadu-Antwi?

7.38 p.m.

Mr Anyimadu-Antwi: Mr Speaker, I would not have minded if we were to have enough Bills for the Consideration Stage. Mr Speaker, I am told that you directed that copies of the Bill be served on Hon Members and they are making copies to serve us. As we sit here, about four of us are using one Bill—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So, Mr Anyimadu-Antwi, first to address the issue, today, we did not even start Sitting at 2 o'clock. We started Sitting after 3 o'clock, so before five hours, I do not have the power to adjourn the House. But after five hours, I have the power to adjourn the House. So, in view of the fact that we started Sitting at 3 o'clock, Prof Kingsley Nyarko, your application to me is not within my domain.

Let us address the issue of Mr Anyimadu-Antwi. Yes, it is an important point you raised. So, the view is that, like establishment of the board, the duties and liabilities of the board, tenure of office of members of the board, and meetings of the board, these are templates and standard provisions in various laws, except that we are deciding to litigate it, but I am amenable.

Mr Anyimadu-Antwi: Mr Speaker, I was going to urge Leadership to move a Motion once we have started the consideration. Then, I will urge the Table

to give us enough copies to peruse, so that we can make meaningful discussions tomorrow. There is no point rushing through to have a bad law. We do not need to rush through the Bill. That would be my proposal.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well. Hon Majority Chief Whip, the proposal is coming from the Minority, so let me hear them.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, I agree with Mr Anyimadu-Antwi, except that we had an agreement that, at least, if we are done with clause 5, then we could take an adjournment for tomorrow. It is true that they do not have enough copies and they are struggling with the copies. If Hon Members do not have enough copies, they will not be able to make meaningful contributions to the Bill and the Bill is important.

So, if we can just end at clause five, so that Table can make enough copies available to us today and we can continue with other parts tomorrow. I had that engagement with the Hon Majority Chief Whip that we should end at clause 5.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon Majority Chief Whip?

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, indeed we engaged and the agreement was that, if you may note, clause 6 is such a brief clause, so we agreed that we will add it to clause 5 and clear it—*[Interruption]*—Please.

So, we were hoping that upon clearing clause 5, we will take clause 6 quickly

and then bring proceedings to a close. Then we will encourage the Table to make sufficient copies of the Bills available to Members tomorrow for tomorrow's work. Then our Brother—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Clause 5 has actually been deferred.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Yes, Mr Speaker, then it means that we may have to draw the curtains down.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: So, move a Motion for adjournment.

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: Mr Speaker, like I indicated, Table should try to make sufficient copies available today because it is such an important Bill. Mr Speaker, as you can see, I have about three first-timers who are by our senior Colleague, Mr Anyimadu-Antwi; they want to learn.

Also, Mr Speaker, before my Colleague moves the Motion for adjournment, even though we are done with this to continue tomorrow, we are of the view that we should schedule the Minister for Finance for Committee of the Whole tomorrow as we have a lot of outstanding that are of importance. I think the Minister for Finance should meet us as a Committee of the Whole tomorrow to address many other issues that affect Hon Members, which I cannot say—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Member, let me give this guideline again. Concerning certain things, I would prefer if the Whips engage rather than speaking to the record.

[Pause]

Very well, before you move the Motion, Hon Members, I have—Yes, we have come to the end of the Consideration Stage for today.

Hon Minister, I would urge upon you that you bring more copies of the Bill tomorrow to be distributed to Hon Members.

Mrs Arthur: Yes, Mr Speaker. Actually, we have made arrangements; we are surprised they are not here, but we will ensure that they come.

Thank you.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Very well, so that we can make progress.

Hon Members, my attention has been drawn to a referral I made yesterday in respect of the Ghana Scholarship Authority Bill, 2025 to the Committee responsible for Education.

Hon Members, pursuant to Order 260 (2) of the Standing Orders, the Committee on Public Administration and State Interests shall have referred to it, matters that relate to state interests and public administration and has jurisdiction to investigate and enquire into the activities and administration of some state institutions, including the Scholarship Secretariat.

Accordingly, the Ghana Scholarship Authority Bill, 2025 is hereby referred to the Joint Committee on Public Administration and State Interests and

Committee on Education for consideration and report. So, instead of only the Committee on Education, it is now the Joint Committee. So, the two Committees should take note and collaborate.

Yes, Majority Chief Whip, you may now move the Motion?

Majority Chief Whip (Mr Rockson-Nelson Etse Kwami Dafeamekpor): Mr Speaker, I move that in the absence of any further Business, the House be adjourned to tomorrow.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Majority Chief Whip, we have further Business, but we just stopped at clause 4 and, unfortunately, we have not done five hours.

Mr Dafeamekpor: Mr Speaker, I agree we have not done five hours, but given the solemnity of the mood of the House, I pray that we bring the proceedings of today to a close, then we can come back tomorrow at 2.00 p.m. to do further battle.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Yes, Hon First Deputy Minority Whip?

First Deputy Minority Whip (Alhaji Habib Iddrisu): Mr Speaker, the Majority Chief Whip, as you can see,

should take a cue that we, in the Minority, are always collaborating with them and ready to work. We have done the Fisheries and Aquaculture Bill, 2025 up to clause 5. He can check behind him; I do not need to say anything—

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Well, Majority Chief Whip, they are collaborating with you and are ready to work; clause 6—

Alhaji Habib Iddrisu: So, Mr Speaker, we have been able to help them and if he looks behind him, he will understand and the Minister for Fisheries and Aquaculture Development can also check her back.

Mr Speaker, I second the Motion for adjournment.

Question put and Motion agreed to.

Mr First Deputy Speaker: Hon Members, the House is accordingly adjourned till Thursday, 10th July, 2025, at 2 o'clock in the forenoon.

Thank you very much, Hon Members.

ADJOURNMENT

The House was accordingly adjourned at 7.48 p.m. till Thursday, 10th July, 2025, at 2:00 p.m.

